

Ovarian Cancer Histotypes: Report of Statistical Findings

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Preface

This report of statistical findings describes the classification of ovarian cancer histotypes using data from NanoString CodeSets.

Marina Pavanello conducted the initial exploratory data analysis, Cathy Tang implemented class imbalance techniques, Derek Chiu conducted the normalization and statistical analysis, and Lauren Tindale and Aline Talhouk are the project leads.

1 Introduction

Ovarian cancer has five major histotypes: high-grade serous carcinoma (HGSC), low-grade serous carcinoma (LGSC), endometrioid carcinoma (ENOC), mucinous carcinoma (MUC), and clear cell carcinoma (CCOC). A common problem with classifying these histotypes is that there is a class imbalance issue. HGSC dominates the distribution, commonly accounting for 70% of cases in many patient cohorts, while the other four histotypes are spread over the rest of the cases. Subsampling methods like up-sampling, down-sampling, and SMOTE can be used to mitigate this problem.

The supervised learning is performed under a consensus framework: we consider various classification algorithms and use evaluation metrics like accuracy, F1-score, and Kappa, to inform the decision of which methods to carry forward for prediction in confirmation and validation sets.

2 Methods

2.1 Pre-Processing

2.1.1 Case Selection

Prior to pre-processing, samples were split into a training, a confirmation, and a validation set.

- Training
 - CS1: OOU, OOUE, VOA, MAYO, MTL
 - CS2: OOU, OOUE, VOA, MAYO, OVAR3, OVAR11, JAPAN, MTL, POOL-CTRL
 - CS3: OOU, OOUE, VOA, POOL-1, POOL-2, POOL-3
- Confirmation:
 - CS3: TNCO
- Validation:
 - CS3: DOVE4

2.1.2 Quality Control

Before normalization, we calculated several quality control measures and excluded samples that failed to achieve sample quality in one or more of these measures.

- **Linearity of positive control genes:** If the R-squared from a linear model of positive controls and their concentrations is less than 0.95 or missing, then the sample is flagged.
- **Imaging quality:** The sample is flagged if the field of view percentage is less than 75%.
- **Positive Control flag:** We consider the two smallest positive controls at concentrations 0.5 and 1. If these two controls are less than the lower limit of detection (defined as two standard deviations below the mean of the negative control expression), or if the mean negative control expression is 0, the sample is flagged.
- **The signal-to-noise ratio or percent of genes detected:** These two measures are defined as the ratio of the average housekeeping gene expression over the upper limit of detection, defined as two standard deviations above the mean of the negative control expression (or 0 if this limit is less than 0.001), and the proportion of endogenous genes with expression greater than the upper limit of detection. These measures are flagged if they are below a pre-specified threshold, which is determined visually by considering their bivariate distribution in a scatterplot. In this case, we used 100 for the SNR threshold and 50% for the threshold for genes detected. Note: these thresholds were determined by examining the relationship in [Section 3.3.2](#).

2.1.3 Housekeeping Genes Normalization

The full training set (n=1257) comprised of data from three CodeSets (CS) 1, 2, and 3. Data normalization removes technical variation from high-throughput platforms to improve the validity of comparative analyses.

Each CodeSet was first normalized to housekeeping genes: *ACTB*, *RPL19*, *POLR1B*, *SDHA*, and *PGK1*. Housekeeping genes encode proteins responsible for basic cell function and have consistent expression in all cells. All expression values were log2 transformed. Normalization to housekeeping genes corrects the viable RNA from each sample. This is achieved by subtracting the average log (base 2)-transformed expression of the housekeeping genes from the log (base 2)-transformed expression of each gene:

$$\log_2(\text{endogenous gene expression}) - \text{average}(\log_2(\text{housekeeping gene expression})) = \text{relative expression} \quad (2.1)$$

2.1.4 Between CodeSet and Site Normalization

To normalize between CodeSets, we randomly selected five specimens, one from each histotype, among specimens repeated in all three CodeSets. This formed the reference set (Random 1). We selected only one sample from each histotype to use as few samples as possible for normalization and retain the rest for analysis.

A reference-based approach (Talhouk et al. (2016)) was used to normalize CS1 to CS3 and CS2 to CS3 across their common genes:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{X-Norm}_{\text{CS1}} &= X_{\text{CS1}} + \bar{R}_{\text{CS3}} - \bar{R}_{\text{CS1}} \\ \text{X-Norm}_{\text{CS2}} &= X_{\text{CS2}} + \bar{R}_{\text{CS3}} - \bar{R}_{\text{CS2}} \end{aligned} \quad (2.2)$$

Samples in CS3 were processed at three different locations; we also had to normalize for “site” in this CodeSet. Finally, the CS3 expression samples were included in the training set without further normalization:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{X-Norm}_{\text{CS3-USC}} &= X_{\text{CS3-USC}} + \bar{R}_{\text{CS3-VAN}} - \bar{R}_{\text{CS3-USC}} \\ \text{X-Norm}_{\text{CS3-AOC}} &= X_{\text{CS3-AOC}} + \bar{R}_{\text{CS3-VAN}} - \bar{R}_{\text{CS3-AOC}} \end{aligned} \quad (2.3)$$

Finally, the CS3 expression samples were included in the training set without further normalization. The initial training set is assembled by combining all four of the previously mentioned normalized datasets along with the two CS3 expression subsets not used in normalization:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Training Set} &= \text{X-Norm}_{\text{CS1}} + \text{X-Norm}_{\text{CS2}} + \text{X-Norm}_{\text{CS3-USC}} + \text{X-Norm}_{\text{CS3-AOC}} + \text{X-Norm}_{\text{CS3}} + \text{X-Norm}_{\text{CS3-VAN}} \\ &= \text{X-Norm}_{\text{CS1}} + \text{X-Norm}_{\text{CS2}} + \text{X-Norm}_{\text{CS3}} \end{aligned} \quad (2.4)$$

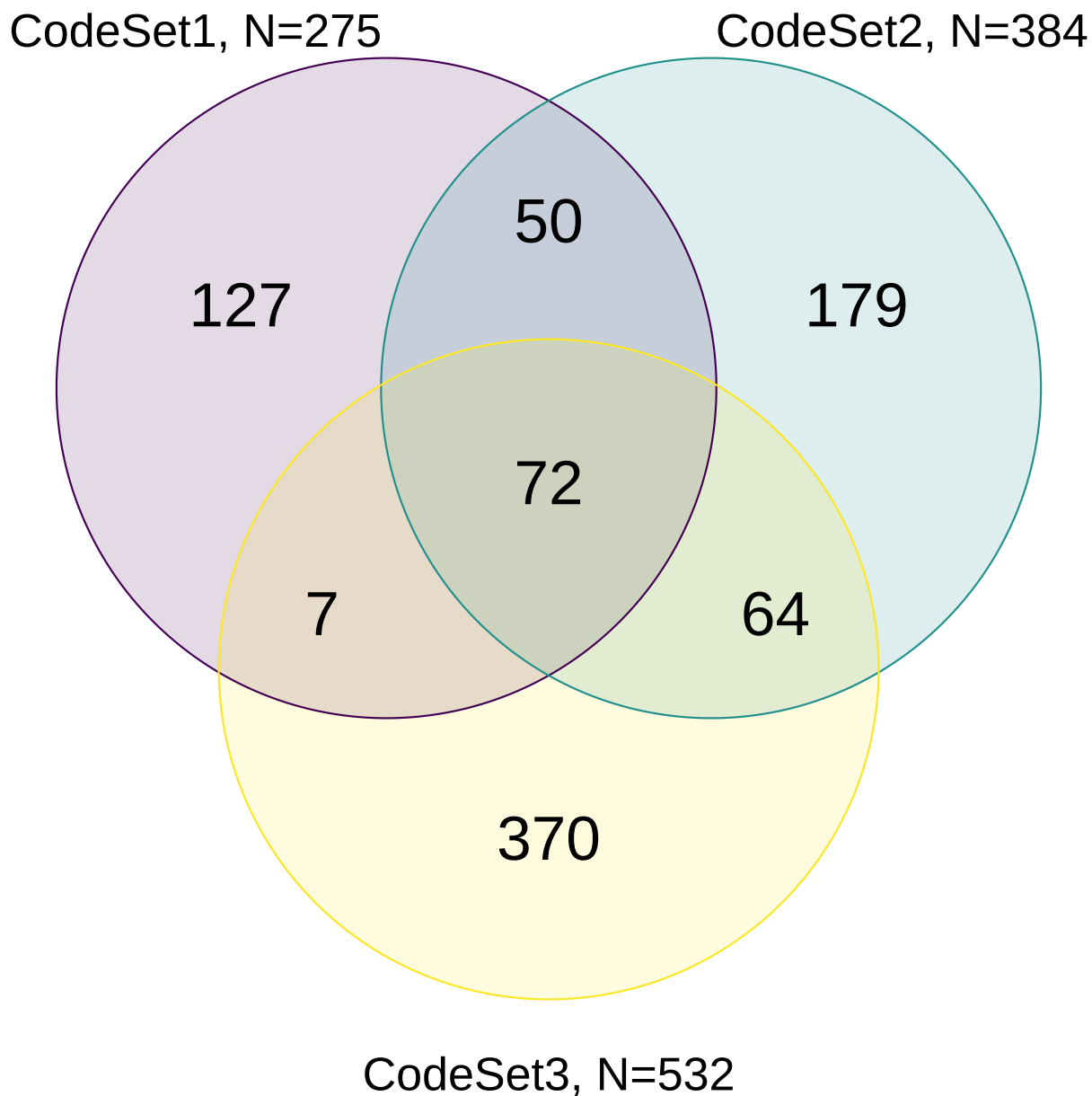


Figure 2.1: Venn diagram of common and unique gene targets covered by each CodeSet

2.1.5 Final Processing

We map ovarian histotypes to all remaining samples and keep the major histotypes for building the predictive model: high-grade serous ovarian carcinoma (HGSOC), clear cell ovarian carcinoma (CCOC), endometrioid ovarian carcinoma (ENOC), mucinous ovarian carcinoma (MUOC), and low-grade serous ovarian carcinoma (LGSOC).

Duplicate cases (two samples with the same ottaID) were removed before generating the final training set to use for fitting the classification models. All CS3 cases were preferred over CS1

and CS2, and CS3-Vancouver cases were preferred over CS3-AOC and CS3-USC when selecting duplicates.

The final training set used only genes that were common across all three CodeSets.

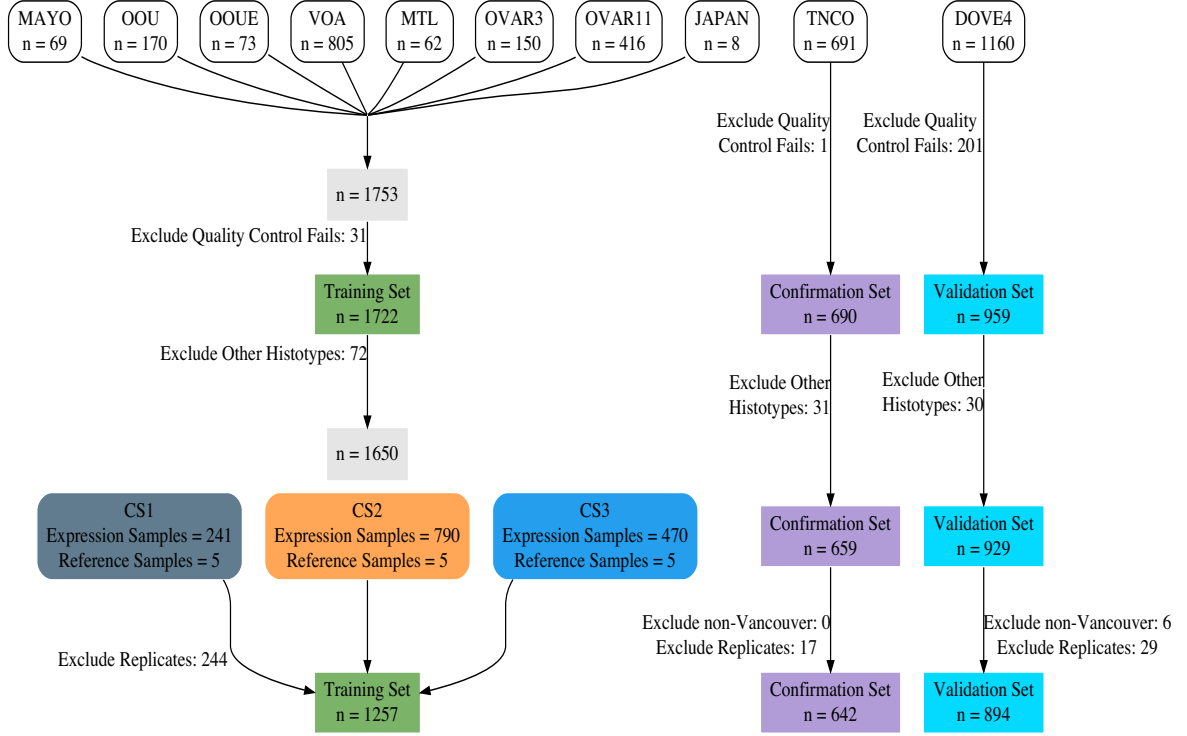


Figure 2.2: Cohorts Selection

2.2 Classifiers

We use 4 classification algorithms in the supervised learning framework for the Training Set. The pipeline was run using SLURM batch jobs submitted to a partition on a CentOS 7 server. All resampling techniques, pre-processing, model specification, hyperparameter tuning, and evaluation metrics were implemented using the `tidymodels` suite of packages. The classifiers we used are:

- Random Forest (`rf`)
- Support Vector Machine (`svm`)
- XGBoost (`xgb`)
- Regularized Multinomial Regression (`mr`)

2.2.1 Resampling of Training Set

We used a nested cross-validation design to assess each classifier while also performing hyperparameter tuning. An outer 5-fold CV stratified by histotype was used together with an inner 5-fold CV with 2 repeats stratified by histotype. This design was chosen such that the test sets of the inner resamples would still have a reasonable number of samples belonging to the smallest minority class.

The outer resampling method cannot be the bootstrap, because the inner training and inner test sets will likely contain the same samples as a result of sampling with replacement in the outer training set. This phenomenon might result in inflated performance as some observations are used both to train and evaluate the hyperparameter tuning in the inner loop.

2.2.2 Hyperparameter Tuning

The following specifications for each classifier were used for tuning hyperparameters:

- **rf** and **xgb**: The number of trees were fixed at 500. Other hyperparameters were tuned across 10 randomly selected points in a latin hypercube design.
- **svm**: Both the cost and sigma hyperparameters were tuned across 10 randomly selected points in a latin hypercube design. We tuned the cost parameter in the range $[1, 8]$. The range for tuning the sigma parameter was obtained from the 10% and 90% quantiles of the estimation using the `kernlab::sigest()` function.
- **mr**: We generated 10 randomly selected points in a latin hypercube design for the penalty (lambda) parameter. Then, we generated 10 evenly spaced points in $[0, 1]$ for the mixture (alpha) parameter in the regularized multinomial regression model. These two sets of 10 points were crossed to generate a tuning grid of 100 points.

The hyperparameter combination that resulted in the highest average F1-score across the inner training sets was selected for each classifier to use as the model for assessing prediction performance in the outer training loop.

2.2.3 Subsampling

Here are the specifications of the subsampling methods used to handle class imbalance:

- **None**: No subsampling is performed
- **Down-sampling**: All levels except the minority class are sampled down to the same frequency as the minority class
- **Up-sampling**: All levels except the majority class are sampled up to the same frequency as the majority class
- **SMOTE**: All levels except the majority class have synthetic data generated until they have the same frequency as the majority class
- **Hybrid**: All levels except the majority class have synthetic data generated up to 50% of the frequency of the majority class, then the majority class is sampled down to the same frequency as the rest.

The figure below helps visualize how the distribution of classes changes when we apply subsampling techniques to handle class imbalance:

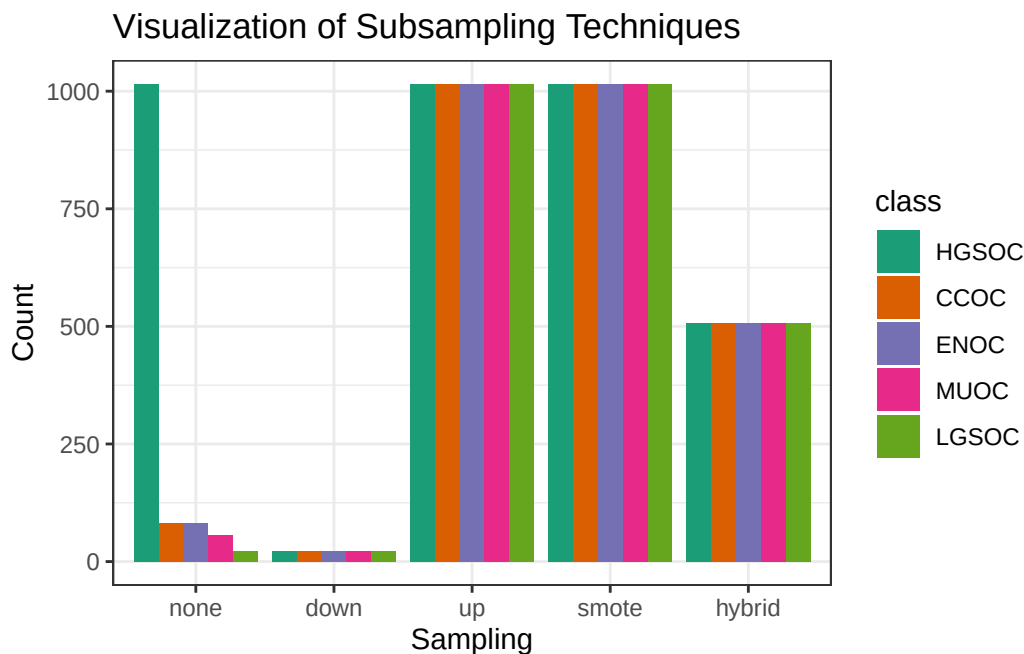


Figure 2.3: Visualization of Subsampling Techniques

2.2.4 Workflows

The 4 **algorithms** and 5 **subsampling** methods are crossed to create 20 different classification **workflows**. For example, the `hybrid_xgb` workflow is a classifier that first pre-processes a training set by applying a hybrid subsampling method, and then proceeds to use the XGBoost algorithm to classify ovarian histotypes.

2.3 Two-Step Algorithm

The HGSOC histotype comprises of approximately 80% of cases among ovarian carcinoma patients, while the remaining 20% of cases are relatively, evenly distributed among ENOC, CCOC, MUOC, and LGSOC histotypes. We can implement a two-step algorithm as such:

- Step 1: use binary classification for HGSOC vs. non-HGSOC
- Step 2: use multinomial classification for the remaining non-HGSOC classes

Let

$$\begin{aligned}
 X_k &= \text{Training data with } k \text{ classes} \\
 C_k &= \text{Class with highest } F_1 \text{ score from training } X_k \\
 W_k &= \text{Workflow associated with } C_k
 \end{aligned}
 \tag{2.5}$$

Figure 2.4 shows how the two-step algorithm works:

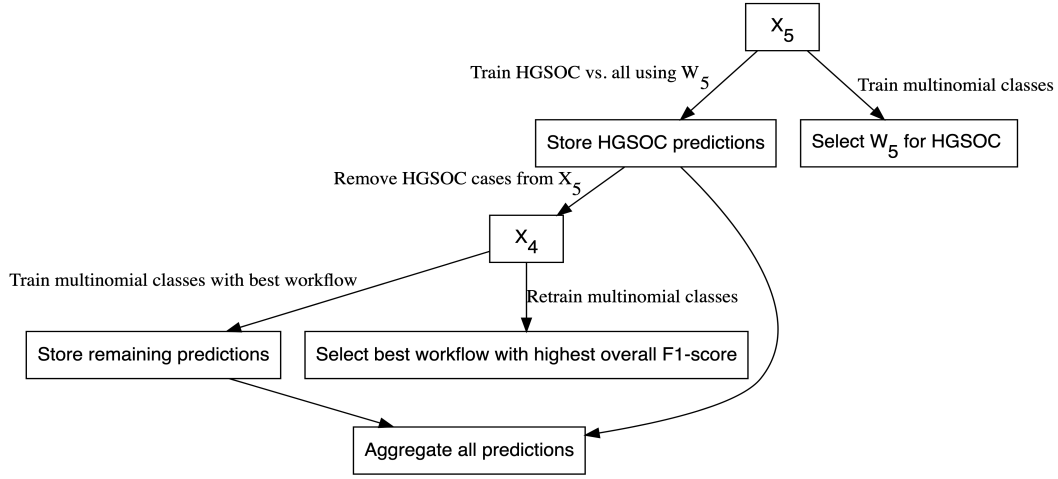


Figure 2.4: Two-Step Algorithm

2.3.1 Aggregating Predictions

The aggregation for two-step predictions is quite straightforward:

1. Predict HGSOc vs. non-HGSOc
2. Among all non-HGSOc cases, predict CCOC vs. LGSOC vs. MUOC vs. ENOC

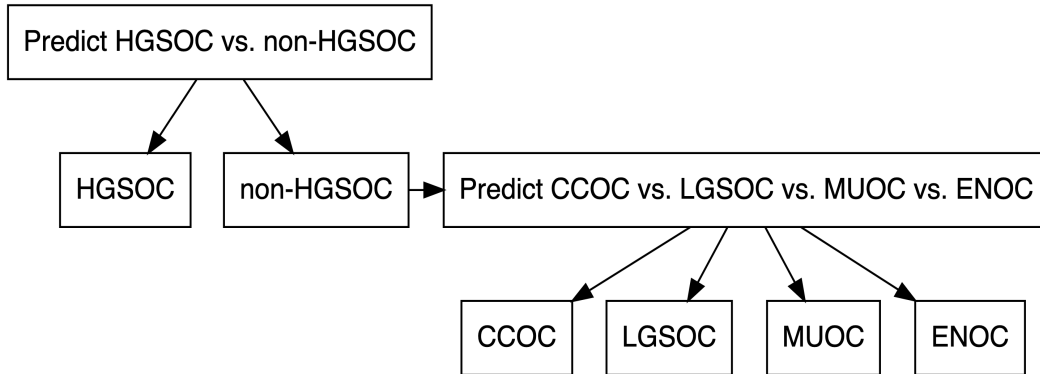


Figure 2.5: Aggregating Predictions for Two-Step Algorithm

2.4 Sequential Algorithm

Instead of training on k classes simultaneously using multinomial classifiers, we can use a sequential algorithm that performs $k-1$ one-vs-all binary classifications iteratively to obtain a final prediction of all cases. At each step in the sequence, we classify one class vs. all other classes, where the classes that make up the “other” class are those not equal to the current “one” class and excluding all “one” classes from previous steps. For example, if the “one” class in step 1 was HGSOc, the

“other” classes would include CCOC, ENOC, LGSOC, and MUOC. If the “one” class in step 2 was CCOC, the “other” classes include ENOC, LGSOC, and MUOC.

The order of classes and workflows to use at each step in the sequential algorithm must be determined using a retraining procedure. After removing the data associated with a particular class, we retrain using the remaining data using multinomial classifiers as described before. The class and workflow to use for the next step in the sequence is selected based on the best per-class evaluation metric value (e.g. F1-score).

Figure 2.6 illustrates how the sequential algorithm works for $K=5$, using ovarian histotypes as an example for the classes.

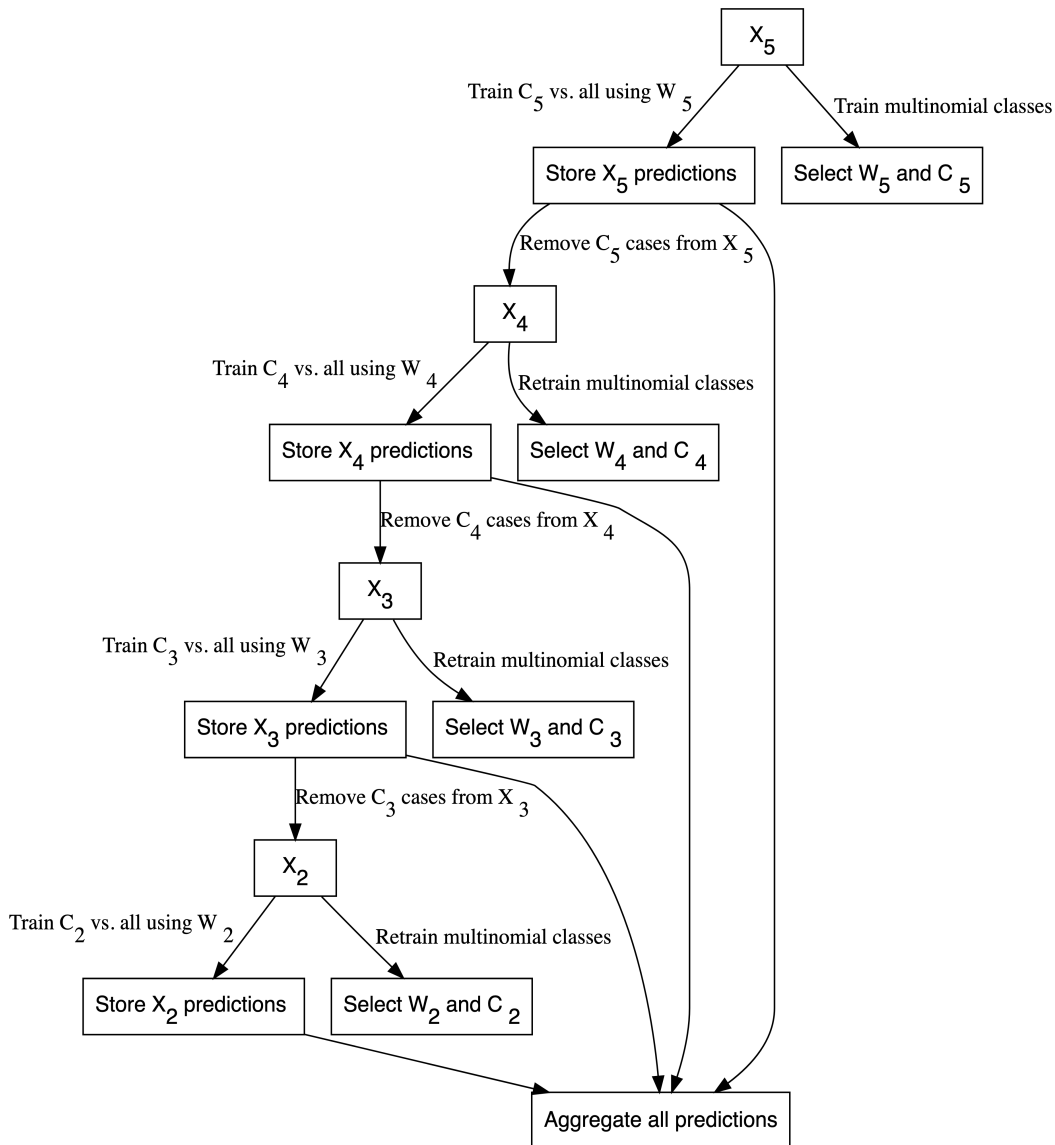


Figure 2.6: Sequential Algorithm

The subsampling method used in the first step of the sequential algorithm is used in all subsequent steps in order to maintain data pre-processing consistency. As a result, we are only comparing

classification algorithms within one subsampling method across the entire sequential algorithm.

2.4.1 Aggregating Predictions

We have to aggregate the one-vs-all predictions from each of the sequential algorithm workflows in order to obtain a final class prediction on a holdout test set. Each sequential workflow has to be assessed on every sample to ensure that cases classified into the “all” class from a previous step of the sequence are eventually assigned a predicted class. For example, say that based on certain class-specific metrics we determined that the order of classes in the sequential algorithm was to predict HGSOc vs. non-HGSOc, CCOC vs. non-CCOC, LGSOC vs. non-LGSOC, and then MUOC vs. ENOC. Figure 2.7 illustrates how the final predictions are assigned:

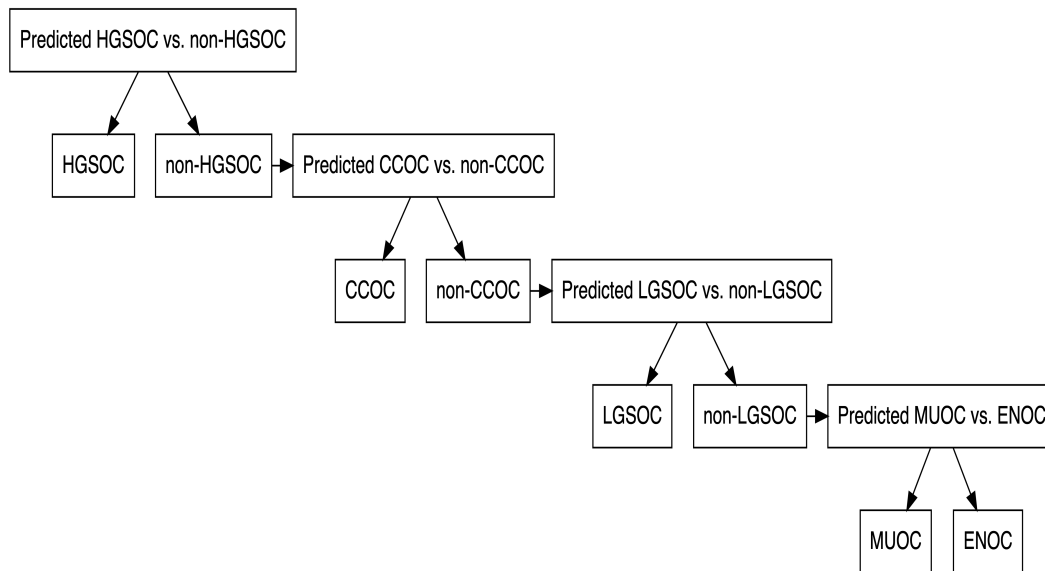


Figure 2.7: Aggregating Predictions for Sequential Algorithm

2.5 Performance Evaluation

2.5.1 Class Metrics

We use the accuracy, sensitivity, specificity, F1-score, kappa, balanced accuracy, and geometric mean, as class metrics to measure both training and test performance between different workflows. Multiclass extensions of these metrics can be calculated except for F1-score, where we use macro-averaging to obtain an overall metric. Class-specific metrics are calculated by recoding classes into one-vs-all categories for each class.

2.5.1.1 Accuracy

The accuracy is defined as the proportion of correct predictions out of all cases:

$$\text{accuracy} = \frac{TP}{TP + FP + FN + TN} \quad (2.6)$$

2.5.1.2 Sensitivity

Sensitivity is the proportional of correctly predicted positive cases, out of all cases that were truly positive

$$\text{sensitivity} = \frac{TP}{TP + FN} \quad (2.7)$$

2.5.1.3 Specificity

Specificity is the proportional of correctly predicted negative cases, out of all cases that were truly negative.

$$\text{specificity} = \frac{TN}{TN + FP} \quad (2.8)$$

2.5.1.4 F1-Score

The F-measure can be thought of as a harmonic mean between precision and recall:

$$F_{meas} = \frac{(1 + \beta^2) \times \text{precision} \times \text{recall}}{(\beta^2 \times \text{precision}) + \text{recall}} \quad (2.9)$$

The β value can be adjusted to place more weight upon precision or recall. The most common value is β is 1, which is also commonly known as the F1-score. A multiclass extension doesn't exist for the F1-score, so we use macro-averaging to calculate this metric when there are more than two classes. For example, with k classes, the macro-averaged F1-score is equal to:

$$F_{1_{macro}} = \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k F_{1_i} \quad (2.10)$$

where each F_{1_i} is the F1-score computed from recoding classes into $k = i$ vs. $k \neq i$.

In situations where there is not at least one predicted case for each of the classes (e.g. for a poor classifier), F_{1_i} is undefined because the per-class precision of class i is undefined. Those F_{1_i} terms are removed from the $F_{1_{macro}}$ equation and the resulting value may be inflated. Interpreting the F1-score in such a case would be misleading.

2.5.1.5 Balanced Accuracy

Balanced accuracy is the arithmetic mean of sensitivity and specificity.

$$\text{Balanced Accuracy} = \frac{\text{Sensitivity} + \text{Specificity}}{2} \quad (2.11)$$

2.5.1.6 Kappa

Kappa is defined as:

$$\text{kappa} = \frac{p_0 - p_e}{1 - p_e} \quad (2.12)$$

where p_0 is the observed agreement among raters and p_e is the hypothetical probability of agreement due to random chance.

2.5.2 AUC

The area under the receiver operating curve (AUC) is calculated by adding up the area under the curve formed by plotting sensitivity vs. 1 - specificity. The Hand-till method is used as a multiclass extension for the AUC.

We did not use AUC to measure class-specific training set performance because combining predicted probabilities in a one-vs-all fashion might be potentially misleading. The sum of probabilities that add up to the “other” class is not equivalent to the predicted probability of the “other” class when using a multiclass classifier.

Instead, we only reported ROC curves and their associated AUCs for test set performance among the highest ranked algorithms.

2.6 Rank Aggregation

To select the best algorithm, we implemented a two-stage rank aggregation procedure using the Genetic Algorithm (Pihur et al. 2009). First, we ranked all workflows based on per-class F1-scores, balanced accuracy, and kappa to see which workflows performed well in predicting all five histotypes. Then, we took the ranks from these three performance metrics and performed a second run of rank aggregation. The top 5 workflows were determined from the final rank aggregation result.

2.7 Gene Optimization

We want to discover an optimal set of genes for the classifiers while including specific genes from other studies such as PrOTYPE and SPOT. A total of 72 genes are used in the classifier training set.

There are 16 genes in the classifier set that overlap with the PrOTYPE classifier: COL11A1, CD74, CD2, TIMP3, LUM, CYTIP, COL3A1, THBS2, TCF7L1, HMGA2, FN1, POSTN, COL1A2, COL5A2, PDZK1IP1, FBN1.

There are also 13 genes in the classifier set that overlap with the SPOT signature: HIF1A, CXCL10, DUSP4, SOX17, MITF, CDKN3, BRCA2, CEACAM5, ANXA4, SERPINE1, TCF7L1, CRABP2, DNAJC9.

We obtain a total of 28 genes from the union of PrOTYPE and SPOT genes that we want to include in the final classifier, regardless of model performance. We then incrementally add genes one at a time from the remaining 44 candidate genes based on a variable importance rank to the set of 28 base genes and recalculate performance metrics. The number of genes at which the performance peaks or starts to plateau may indicate an optimal gene set model for us to compare with the full set model.

Here is the breakdown of genes used and whether they belong to the PrOTYPE and/or SPOT sets:

Table 2.1: Gene Distribution

Genes	PrOTYPE	SPOT
TCF7L1	v	v
COL11A1	v	
CD74	v	
CD2	v	
TIMP3	v	
LUM	v	
CYTIP	v	
COL3A1	v	
THBS2	v	
HMGA2	v	
FN1	v	
POSTN	v	
COL1A2	v	
COL5A2	v	
PDZK1IP1	v	
FBN1	v	
HIF1A		v
CXCL10		v
DUSP4		v
SOX17		v
MITF		v
CDKN3		v

BRCA2	v
CEACAM5	v
ANXA4	v
SERPINE1	v
CRABP2	v
DNAJC9	v
C10orf116	
GAD1	
TPX2	
KGFLP2	
EGFL6	
KLK7	
PBX1	
LIN28B	
TFF3	
MUC5B	
FUT3	
STC1	
BCL2	
PAX8	
GCNT3	
GPR64	
ADCYAP1R1	
IGKC	
BRCA1	
IGJ	
TFF1	
MET	
CYP2C18	
CYP4B1	
SLC3A1	
EPAS1	
HNF1B	
IL6	
ATP5G3	
DKK4	
SEN8	
CAPN2	
C1orf173	
CPNE8	
IGFBP1	
WT1	
TP53	
SEMA6A	
SERPINA5	
ZBED1	
TSPAN8	
SCGB1D2	

2.7.1 Variable Importance

Variable importance is calculated using either a model-based approach if it is available, or a permutation-based VI score otherwise. The variable importance scores are averaged across the outer training folds, and then ranked from highest to lowest.

For the sequential and two-step classifiers, we calculate an overall VI rank by taking the cumulative union of genes at each variable importance rank across all sequences, until all genes have been included.

The variable importance measures are:

- Random Forest: impurity measure (Gini index)
- XGBoost: gain (fractional contribution of each feature to the model based on the total gain of the corresponding features's splits)
- SVM: permutation based p-values
- Multinomial regression: absolute value of estimated coefficients at cross-validated lambda value

3 Distributions

3.1 Histotype Distribution

Table 3.1: Histotype Distribution in Training Set by Processing Stage

Variable	Levels	CS1	CS2	CS3	Total
Selected Cohorts					
Histotype	HGSOC	128 (44%)	655 (73%)	1808 (73%)	2591 (71%)
	CCOC	48 (16%)	62 (7%)	164 (7%)	274 (7%)
	ENOC	60 (20%)	49 (5%)	250 (10%)	359 (10%)
	MUOC	17 (6%)	58 (6%)	68 (3%)	143 (4%)
	LGSOC	19 (6%)	20 (2%)	36 (1%)	75 (2%)
	Other	22 (7%)	59 (7%)	151 (6%)	232 (6%)
Total	N (%)	294 (8%)	903 (25%)	2477 (67%)	3674 (100%)
QC					
Histotype	HGSOC	122 (43%)	641 (73%)	1676 (74%)	2439 (71%)
	CCOC	48 (17%)	62 (7%)	158 (7%)	268 (8%)
	ENOC	60 (21%)	47 (5%)	213 (9%)	320 (9%)
	MUOC	16 (6%)	56 (6%)	65 (3%)	137 (4%)
	LGSOC	18 (6%)	20 (2%)	36 (2%)	74 (2%)
	Other	22 (8%)	56 (6%)	125 (5%)	203 (6%)
Total	N (%)	286 (8%)	882 (26%)	2273 (66%)	3441 (100%)
Main Histotypes					
Histotype	HGSOC	122 (46%)	641 (78%)	1676 (78%)	2439 (75%)
	CCOC	48 (18%)	62 (8%)	158 (7%)	268 (8%)
	ENOC	60 (23%)	47 (6%)	213 (10%)	320 (10%)
	MUOC	16 (6%)	56 (7%)	65 (3%)	137 (4%)
	LGSOC	18 (7%)	20 (2%)	36 (2%)	74 (2%)
Total	N (%)	264 (8%)	826 (26%)	2148 (66%)	3238 (100%)
Removed Duplicates					
	HGSOC	118 (48%)	623 (78%)	1578 (78%)	2319 (76%)

Histotype	CCOC	45 (18%)	56 (7%)	146 (7%)	247 (8%)
	ENOC	56 (23%)	43 (5%)	200 (10%)	299 (10%)
	MUOC	13 (5%)	54 (7%)	55 (3%)	122 (4%)
	LGSOC	14 (6%)	19 (2%)	32 (2%)	65 (2%)
Total	N (%)	246 (8%)	795 (26%)	2011 (66%)	3052 (100%)
Normalized and Recombined					
Histotype	HGSOC	117 (49%)	622 (79%)	454 (97%)	1193 (79%)
	CCOC	44 (18%)	55 (7%)	4 (1%)	103 (7%)
	ENOC	55 (23%)	42 (5%)	4 (1%)	101 (7%)
	MUOC	12 (5%)	53 (7%)	4 (1%)	69 (5%)
	LGSOC	13 (5%)	18 (2%)	4 (1%)	35 (2%)
Total	N (%)	241 (16%)	790 (53%)	470 (31%)	1501 (100%)
Removed Replicates					
Histotype	HGSOC	9 (12%)	552 (78%)	454 (97%)	1015 (81%)
	CCOC	24 (31%)	53 (7%)	4 (1%)	81 (6%)
	ENOC	38 (49%)	40 (6%)	4 (1%)	82 (7%)
	MUOC	3 (4%)	50 (7%)	4 (1%)	57 (5%)
	LGSOC	3 (4%)	15 (2%)	4 (1%)	22 (2%)
Total	N (%)	77 (6%)	710 (56%)	470 (37%)	1257 (100%)

Table 3.2: Histotype Distribution in Training, Confirmation, and Validation Sets

Variable	Levels	Training	Confirmation	Validation
Histotype	HGSOC	1015 (81%)	424 (66%)	699 (78%)
	CCOC	81 (6%)	72 (11%)	69 (8%)
	ENOC	82 (7%)	107 (17%)	88 (10%)
	MUOC	57 (5%)	27 (4%)	23 (3%)
	LGSOC	22 (2%)	12 (2%)	15 (2%)
Total	N (%)	1257 (45%)	642 (23%)	894 (32%)

3.2 Cohort Distribution

Table 3.3: Pre-QC Cohort Distribution by CodeSet

CodeSet	CS1 N = 294	CS2 N = 903	CS3 N = 2,477
Cohort			
OOU	108 (37%)	43 (4.8%)	19 (0.8%)
OOUE	32 (11%)	30 (3.3%)	11 (0.4%)
VOA	145 (49%)	122 (14%)	538 (22%)
OVAR3	0 (0%)	150 (17%)	0 (0%)
OVAR11	0 (0%)	416 (46%)	0 (0%)
MAYO	6 (2.0%)	63 (7.0%)	0 (0%)
DOVE4	0 (0%)	0 (0%)	1,160 (47%)
TNCO	0 (0%)	0 (0%)	691 (28%)
MTL	3 (1.0%)	59 (6.5%)	0 (0%)
JAPAN	0 (0%)	8 (0.9%)	0 (0%)
POOL-CTRL	0 (0%)	12 (1.3%)	0 (0%)
POOL-1	0 (0%)	0 (0%)	31 (1.3%)
POOL-2	0 (0%)	0 (0%)	14 (0.6%)
POOL-3	0 (0%)	0 (0%)	13 (0.5%)

¹ n (%)

3.3 Quality Control

3.3.1 Failed Samples

We use an aggregated **QCFlag** that considers a sample to have failed QC if any of the following QC conditions are flagged:

- Linearity
- Imaging
- Smallest Positive Control
- Normality

Table 3.4: Quality Control Summary

Quality Control Flag	Training N = 1,753	Confirmation N = 691	Validation N = 1,160	Total N = 3,604
Linearity	4 (0.2%)	0 (0%)	0 (0%)	4 (0.1%)
Imaging	3 (0.2%)	0 (0%)	4 (0.3%)	7 (0.2%)
Smallest Positive Control	2 (0.1%)	0 (0%)	0 (0%)	2 (<0.1%)
Normality	26 (1.5%)	1 (0.1%)	197 (17%)	224 (6.2%)
Overall QC	31 (1.8%)	1 (0.1%)	201 (17%)	233 (6.5%)

¹ n (%)

3.3.2 %GD vs. SNR

% Genes Detected vs. Signal-to-Noise Ratio

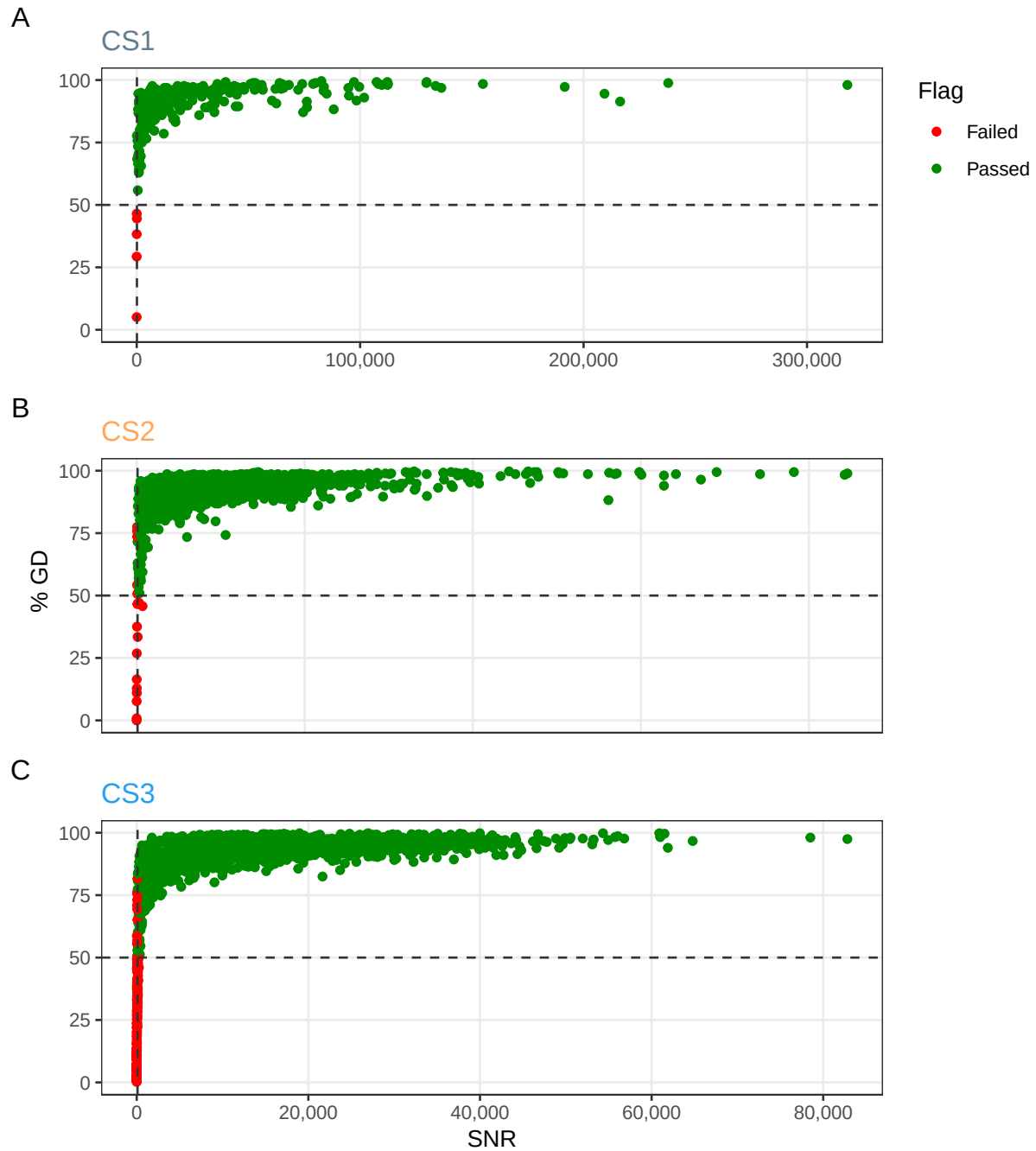


Figure 3.1: % Genes Detected vs. Signal to Noise Ratio

% Genes Detected vs. Signal-to-Noise Ratio (Zoomed)

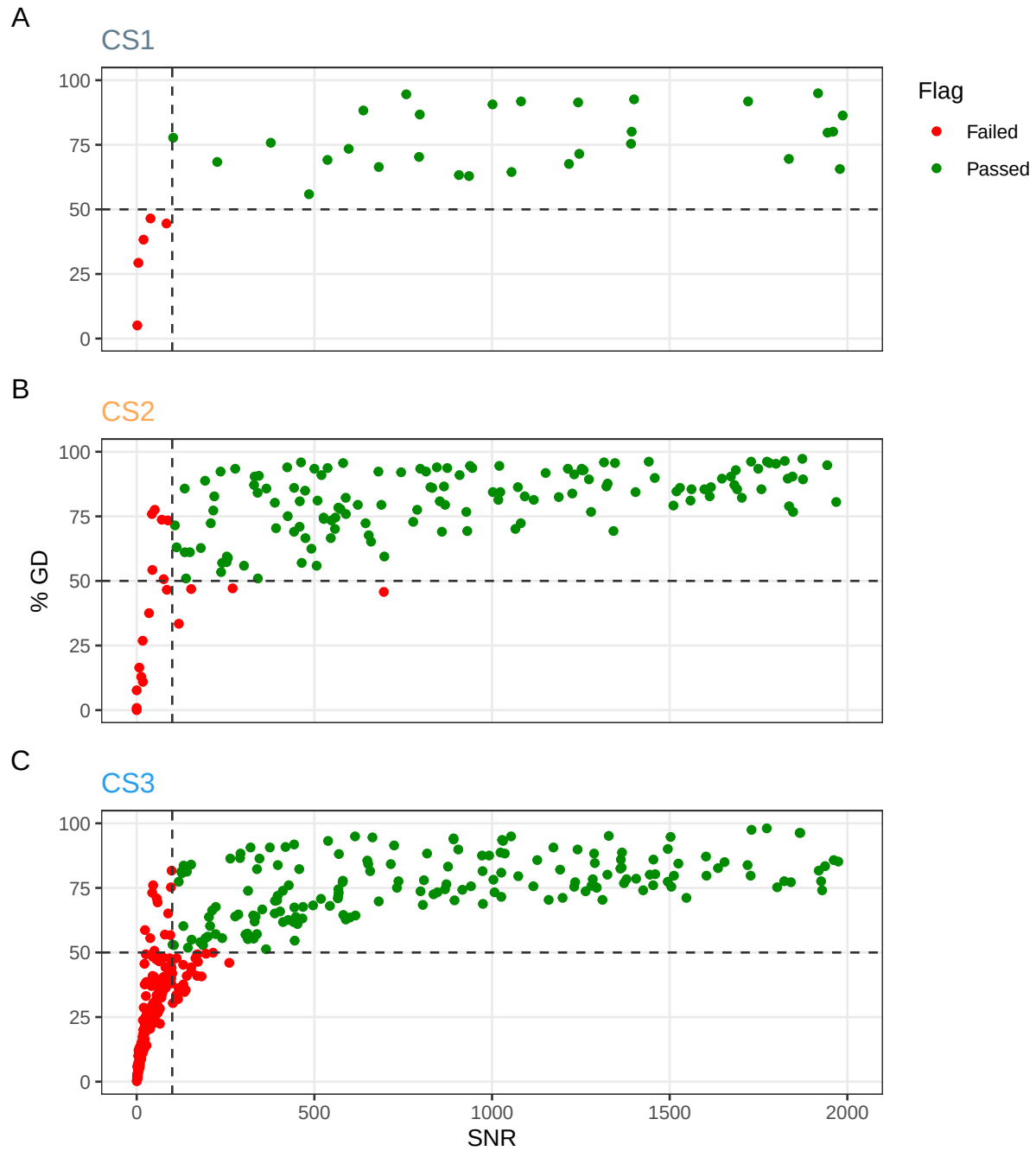


Figure 3.2: % Genes Detected vs. Signal to Noise Ratio (Zoomed)

3.4 Pairwise Gene Expression

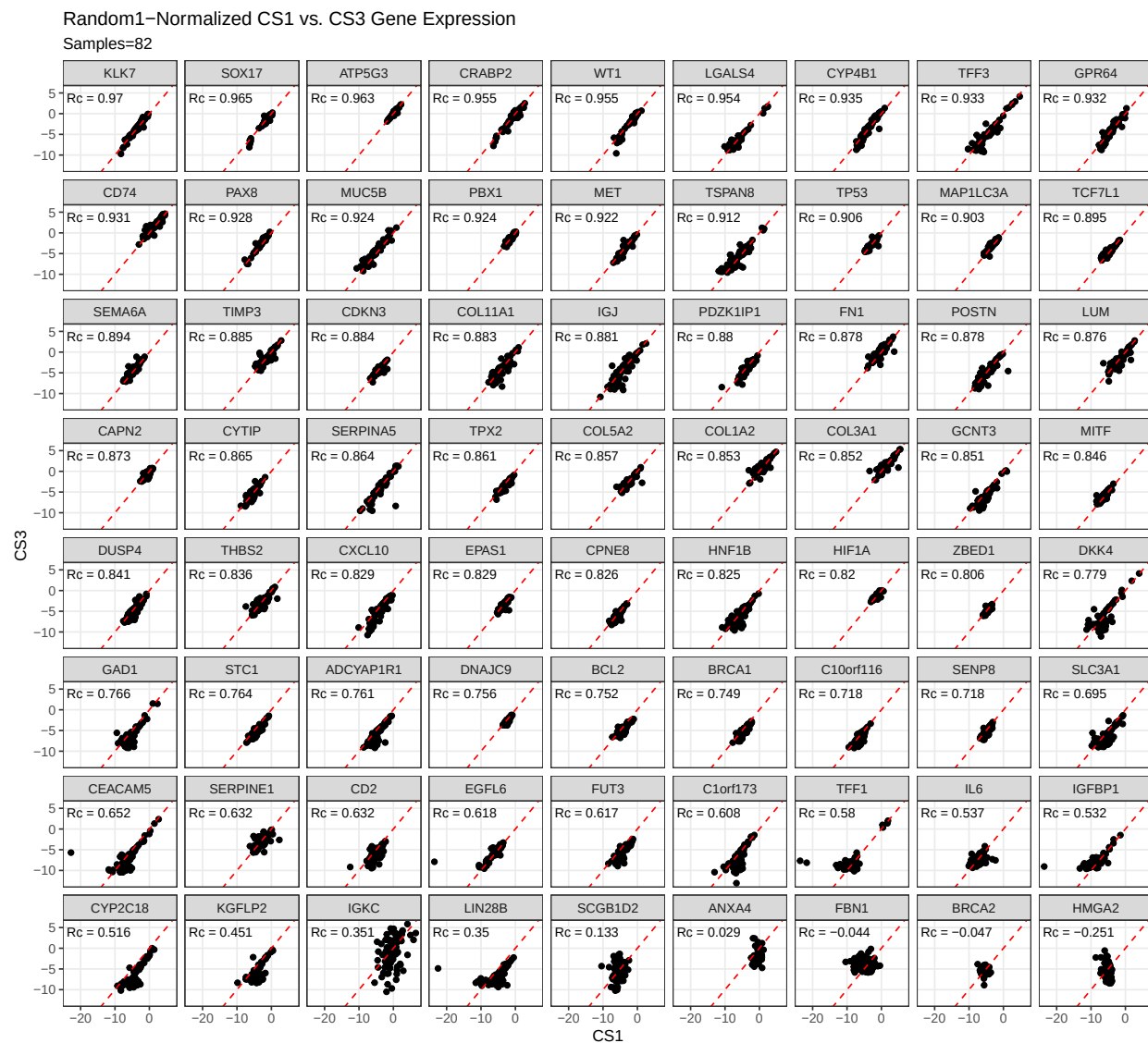


Figure 3.3: Random1-Normalized CS1 vs. CS3 Gene Expression

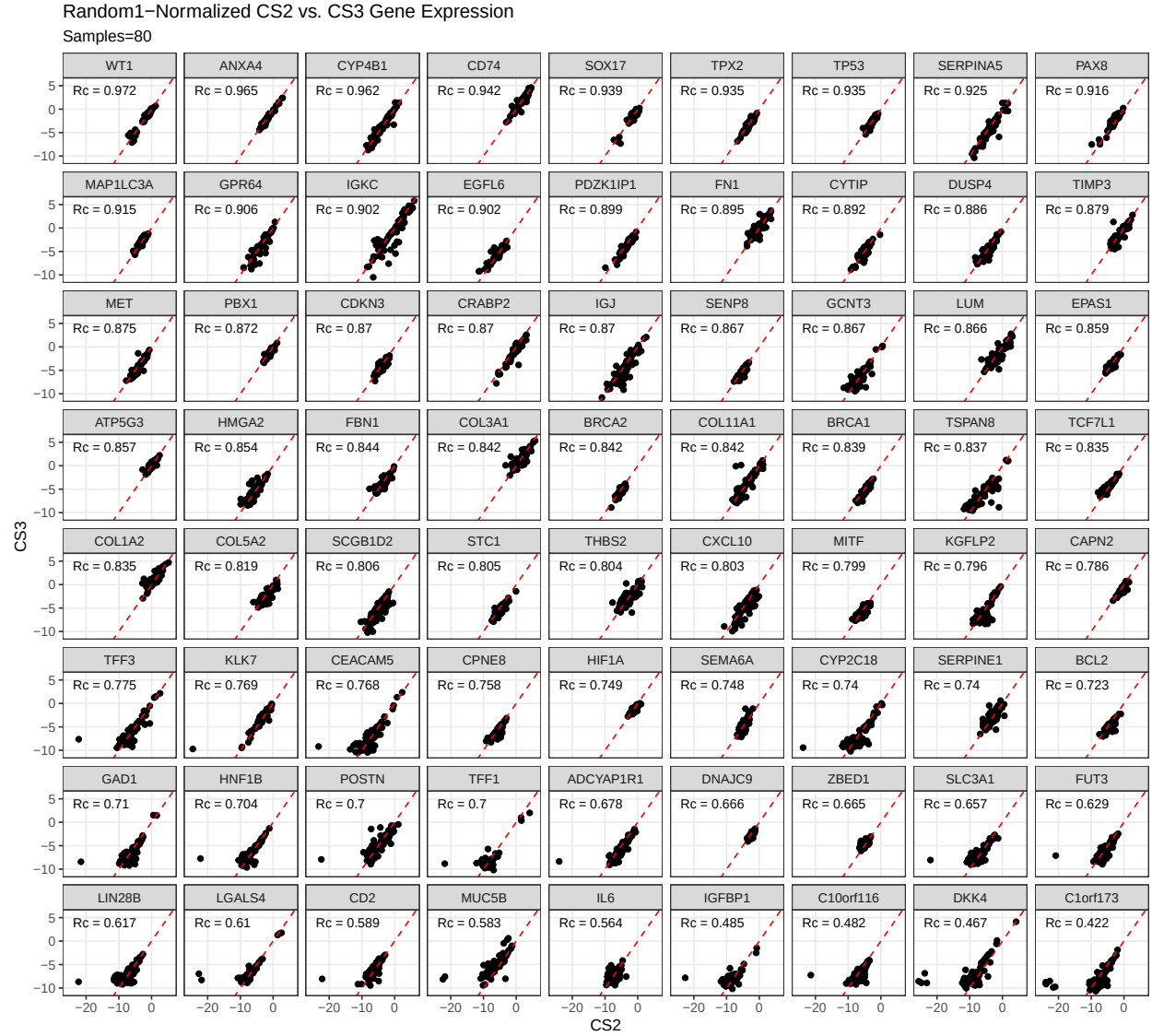


Figure 3.4: Random1-Normalized CS2 vs. CS3 Gene Expression

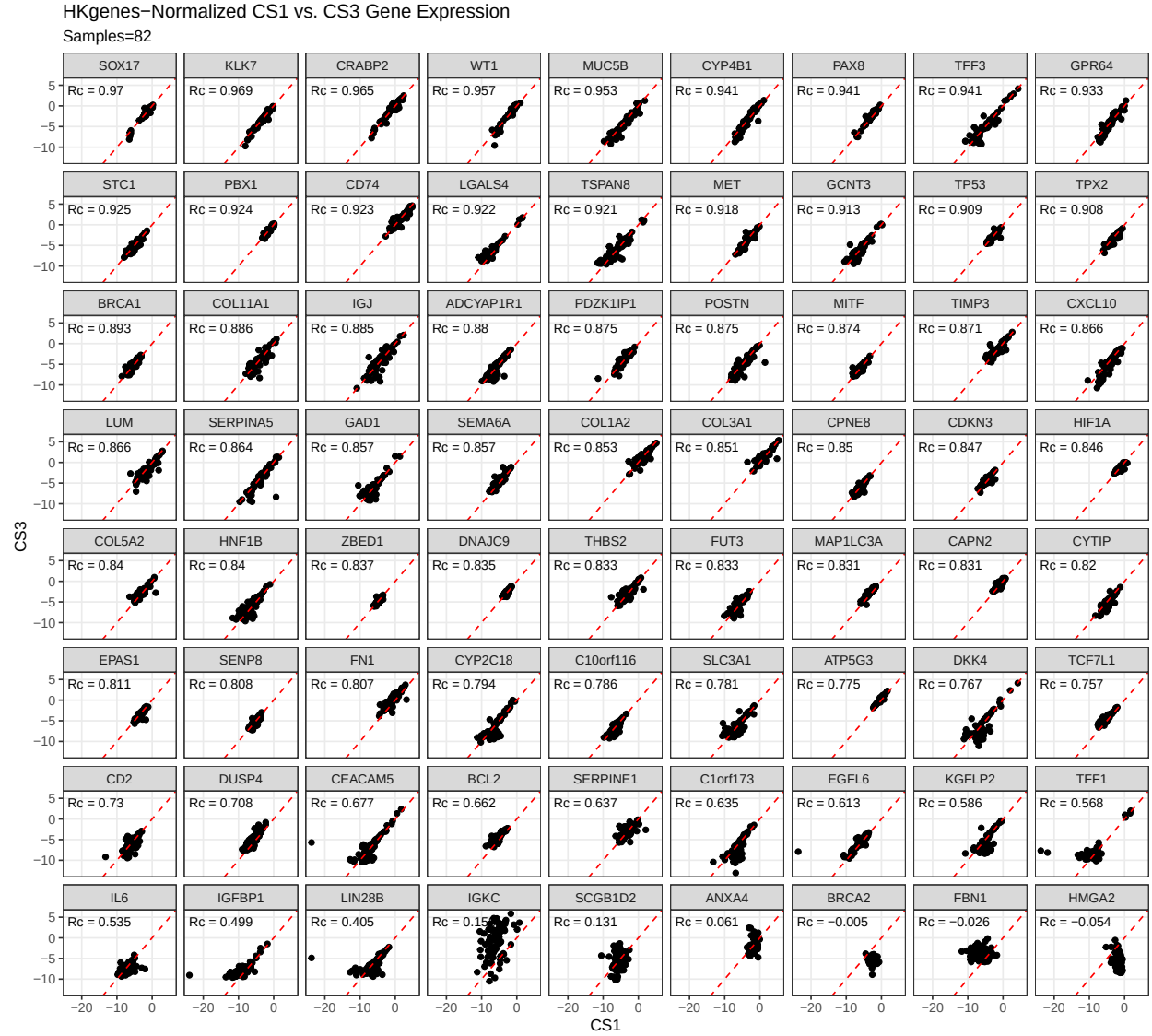


Figure 3.5: HKgenes-Normalized CS1 vs. CS3 Gene Expression

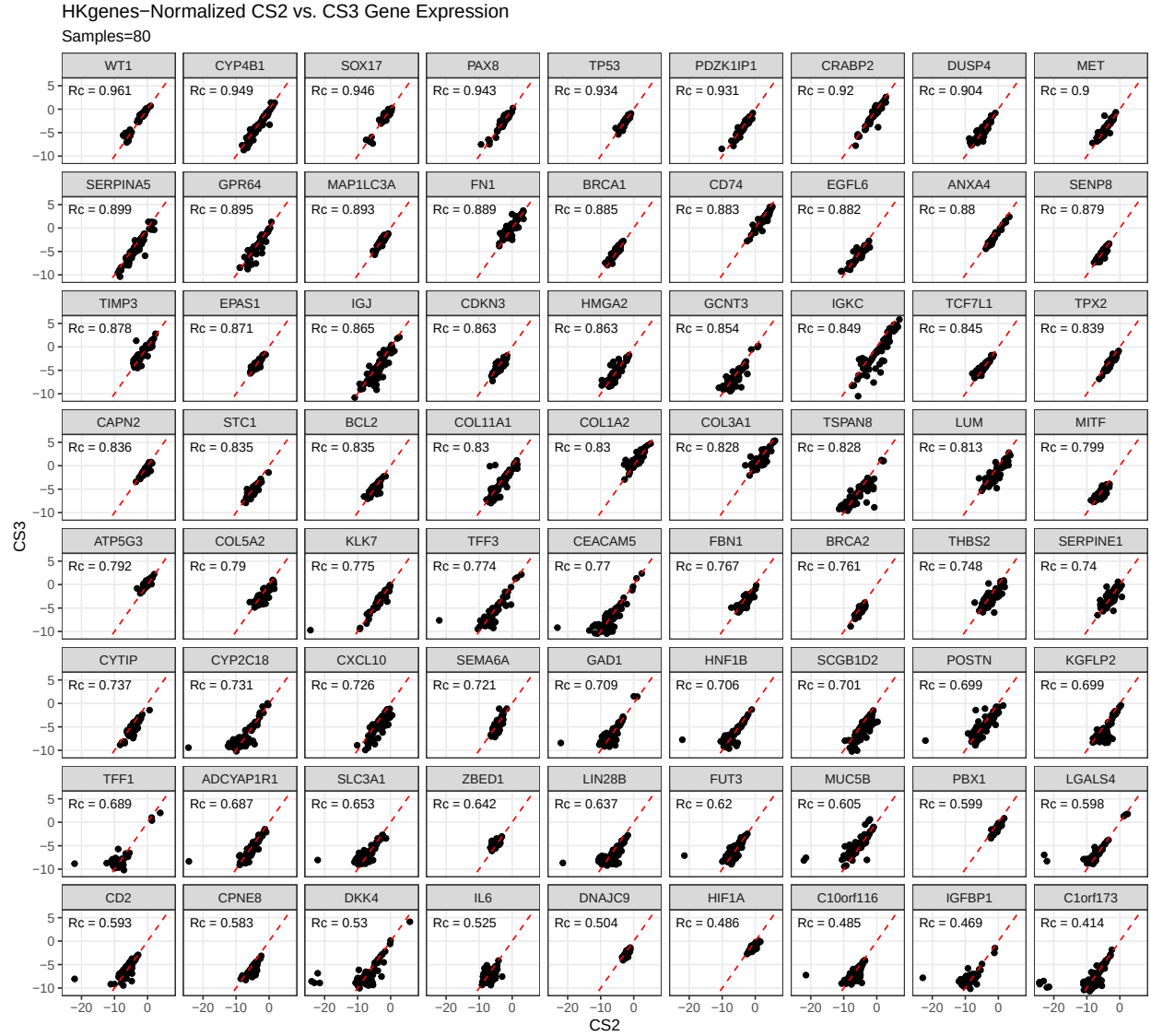


Figure 3.6: HKgenes-Normalized CS2 vs. CS3 Gene Expression

Table 3.5: Wilcoxon signed rank test of gene correlations between normalization methods

Correlation	Housekeeping Genes N = 72 ¹	Random1 N = 72 ¹	p-value ²
CS1 vs. CS3	0.84 (0.74, 0.90)	0.84 (0.67, 0.89)	0.079
CS2 vs. CS3	0.80 (0.69, 0.88)	0.84 (0.72, 0.88)	0.003

¹Median (Q1, Q3)

²Wilcoxon signed rank test with continuity correction

4 Results

We summarize cross-validated training performance of class metrics in the training set. The accuracy, F1-score, and kappa, are the metrics of interest. Workflows are ordered by their mean estimates across the outer folds of the nested CV for each metric.

4.1 Training Set

4.1.1 Accuracy

Table 4.1: Training Set Mean Accuracy

Subsampling	Algorithms	Overall	Histotypes				
			HGSOC	CCOC	ENOC	MUOC	LGSOC
none	rf	0.922	0.948	0.983	0.953	0.975	0.984
	svm	0.92	0.947	0.982	0.955	0.975	0.982
	xgb	0.807	0.809	0.936	0.933	0.955	0.982
	mr	0.807	0.807	0.936	0.935	0.955	0.982
down	rf	0.804	0.853	0.975	0.903	0.959	0.92
	svm	0.793	0.833	0.973	0.884	0.969	0.928
	xgb	0.784	0.829	0.968	0.893	0.968	0.911
	mr	0.827	0.869	0.977	0.911	0.961	0.937
up	rf	0.928	0.955	0.983	0.959	0.979	0.982
	svm	0.92	0.951	0.974	0.951	0.979	0.985
	xgb	0.933	0.96	0.985	0.963	0.977	0.981
	mr	0.89	0.924	0.975	0.948	0.965	0.968
smote	rf	0.921	0.955	0.98	0.953	0.97	0.984
	svm	0.92	0.95	0.979	0.954	0.978	0.981
	xgb	0.924	0.955	0.982	0.956	0.974	0.982
	mr	0.898	0.932	0.979	0.948	0.968	0.968
hybrid	rf	0.922	0.953	0.98	0.952	0.975	0.983
	svm	0.916	0.944	0.982	0.951	0.975	0.979
	xgb	0.923	0.957	0.979	0.954	0.974	0.982
	mr	0.895	0.931	0.979	0.947	0.967	0.967

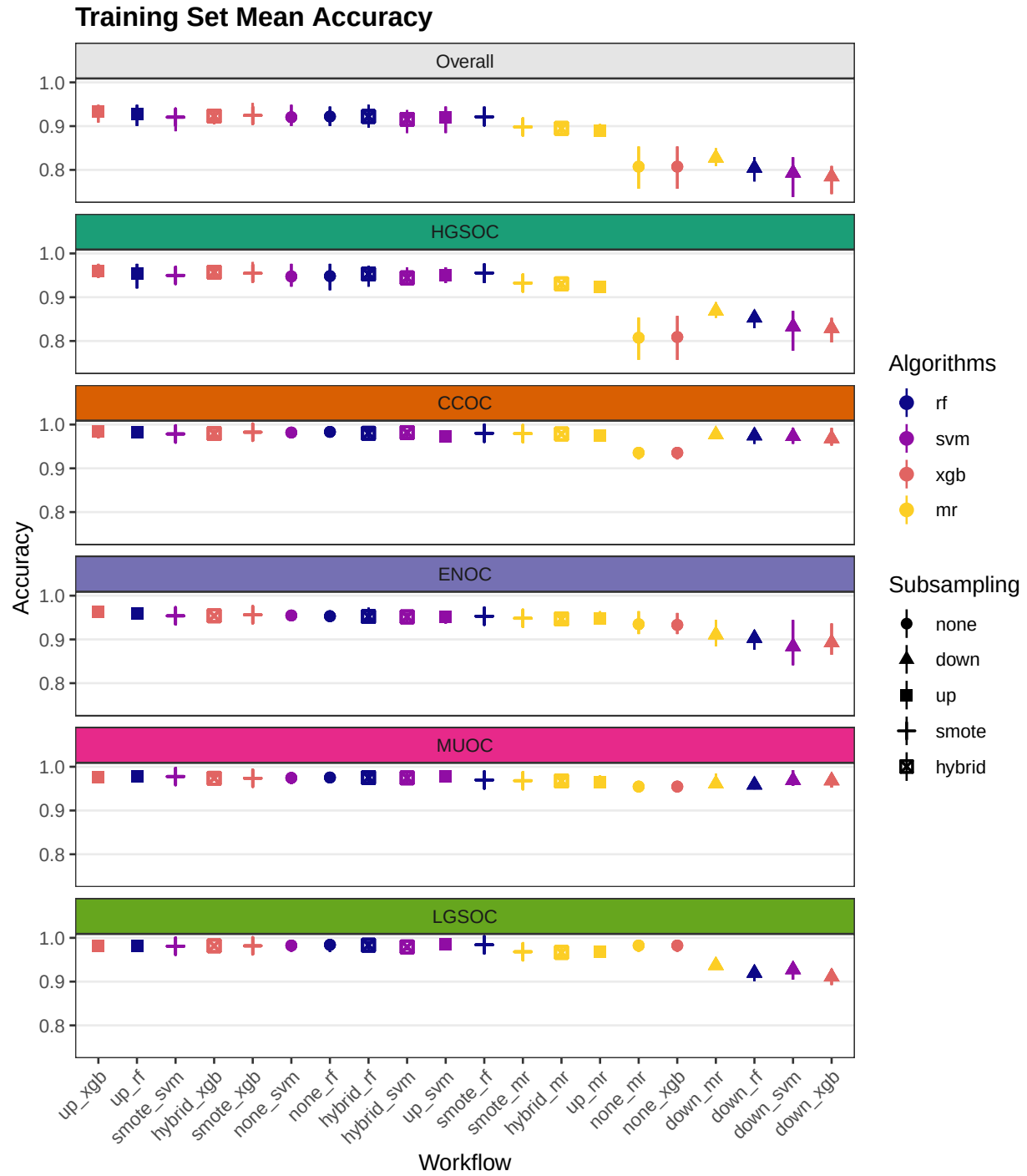


Figure 4.1: Training Set Mean Accuracy

4.1.2 Sensitivity

Table 4.2: Training Set Mean Sensitivity

Subsampling	Algorithms	Overall	Histotypes				
			HGSOC	CCOC	ENOC	MUOC	LGSOC
none	rf	0.636	0.994	0.794	0.498	0.728	0.167
	svm	0.615	0.989	0.762	0.576	0.751	0
	xgb	0.2	1	0	0	0	0
	mr	0.2	1	0	0	0	0
down	rf	0.742	0.83	0.827	0.565	0.657	0.833
	svm	0.779	0.805	0.759	0.611	0.836	0.883
	xgb	0.753	0.798	0.82	0.545	0.837	0.767
	mr	0.775	0.846	0.831	0.62	0.77	0.808
up	rf	0.673	0.988	0.793	0.635	0.766	0.183
	svm	0.714	0.976	0.735	0.625	0.71	0.525
	xgb	0.725	0.981	0.817	0.679	0.8	0.35
	mr	0.787	0.92	0.845	0.666	0.786	0.717
smote	rf	0.658	0.984	0.748	0.618	0.75	0.192
	svm	0.759	0.966	0.757	0.681	0.748	0.642
	xgb	0.741	0.974	0.829	0.606	0.781	0.517
	mr	0.784	0.932	0.821	0.666	0.786	0.717
hybrid	rf	0.72	0.972	0.805	0.638	0.804	0.383
	svm	0.764	0.957	0.793	0.696	0.733	0.642
	xgb	0.747	0.971	0.815	0.604	0.78	0.567
	mr	0.784	0.93	0.809	0.666	0.75	0.767

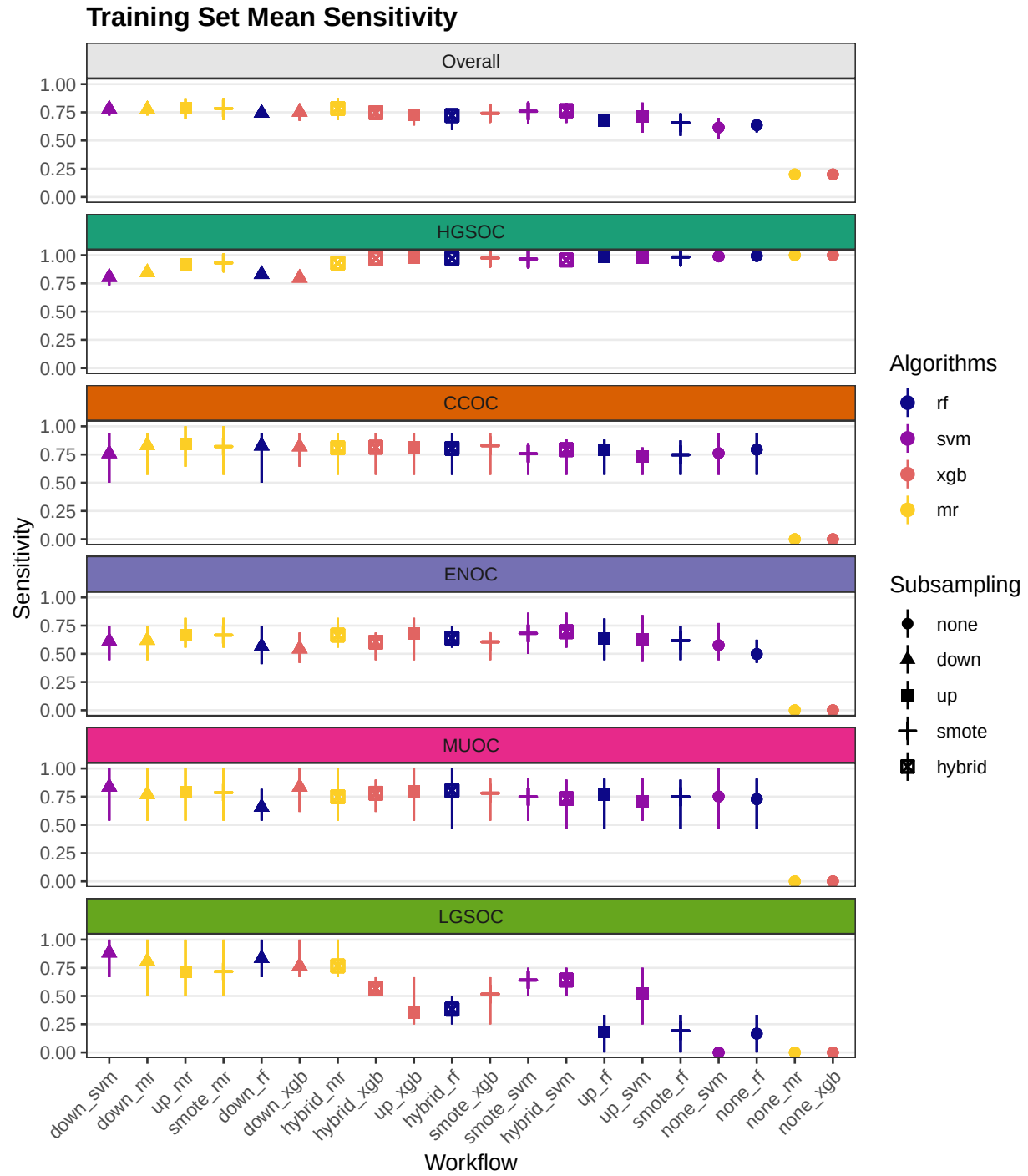


Figure 4.2: Training Set Mean Sensitivity

4.1.3 Specificity

Table 4.3: Training Set Mean Specificity

Subsampling	Algorithms	Overall	Histotypes				
			HGSOC	CCOC	ENOC	MUOC	LGSOC
none	rf	0.946	0.764	0.996	0.985	0.988	0.999
	svm	0.947	0.775	0.997	0.98	0.986	1
	xgb	0.802	0.009	1	0.998	1	1
	mr	0.8	0	1	1	1	1
down	rf	0.952	0.955	0.984	0.928	0.973	0.921
	svm	0.949	0.952	0.987	0.902	0.976	0.928
	xgb	0.949	0.962	0.978	0.917	0.975	0.913
	mr	0.958	0.963	0.986	0.93	0.971	0.939
up	rf	0.957	0.822	0.996	0.98	0.989	0.997
	svm	0.958	0.844	0.99	0.973	0.992	0.993
	xgb	0.966	0.875	0.996	0.981	0.986	0.993
	mr	0.967	0.937	0.984	0.967	0.974	0.973
smote	rf	0.958	0.839	0.996	0.975	0.981	0.998
	svm	0.964	0.88	0.993	0.971	0.989	0.987
	xgb	0.965	0.878	0.992	0.98	0.983	0.991
	mr	0.968	0.934	0.99	0.967	0.977	0.973
hybrid	rf	0.964	0.874	0.992	0.974	0.984	0.994
	svm	0.965	0.89	0.994	0.968	0.987	0.985
	xgb	0.968	0.9	0.99	0.977	0.983	0.99
	mr	0.967	0.934	0.99	0.965	0.978	0.97

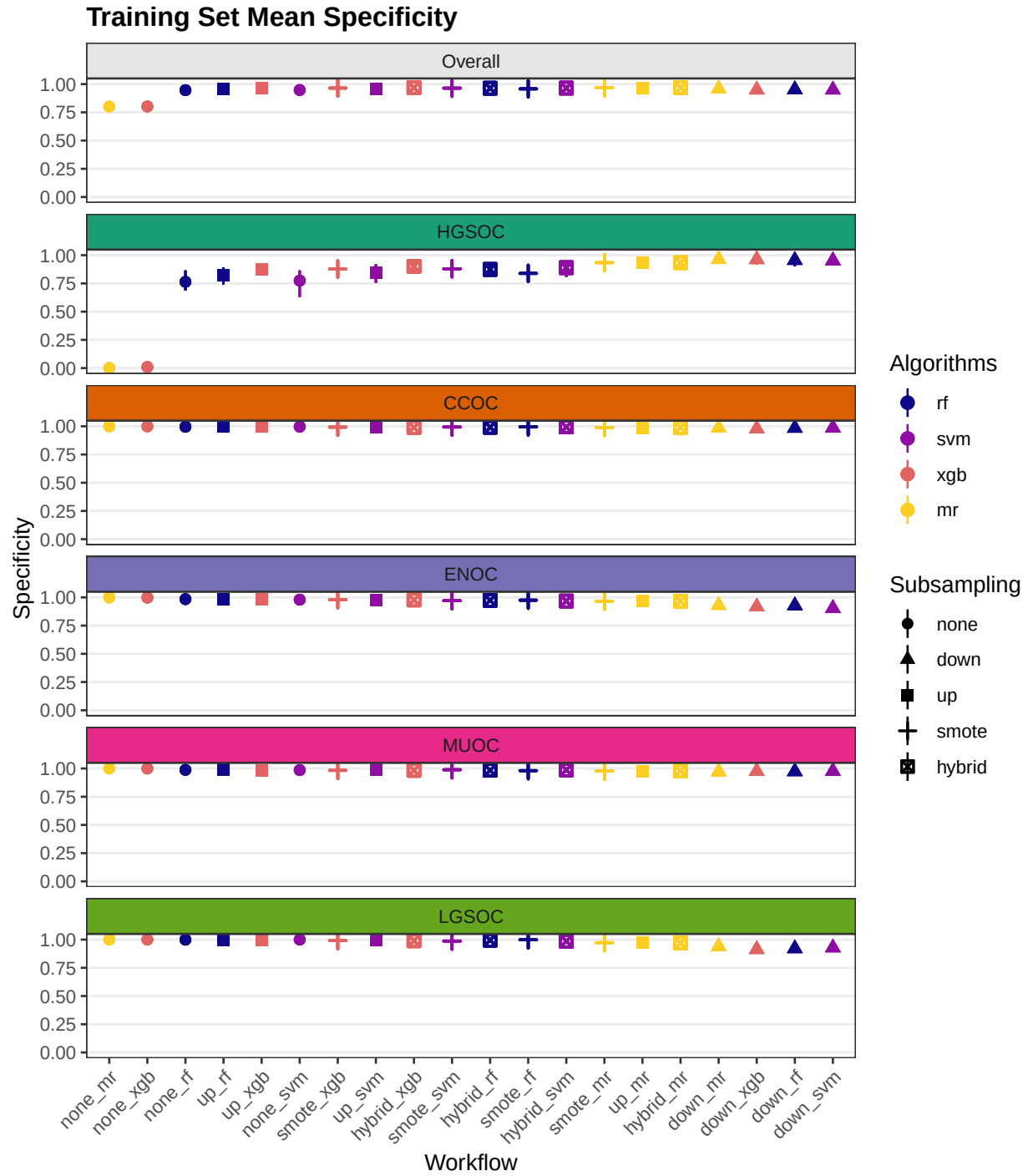


Figure 4.3: Training Set Mean Specificity

4.1.4 F1-Score

Table 4.4: Training Set Mean F1-Score

Subsampling	Algorithms	Overall	Histotypes				
			HGSOC	CCOC	ENOC	MUOC	LGSOC
none	rf	0.733	0.968	0.848	0.568	0.723	0.4
	svm	0.782	0.968	0.834	0.607	0.719	NaN
	xgb	0.712	0.894	NaN	0	NaN	NaN
	mr	0.893	0.893	NaN	NaN	NaN	NaN
down	rf	0.594	0.901	0.799	0.419	0.589	0.262
	svm	0.617	0.886	0.778	0.412	0.713	0.295
	xgb	0.597	0.883	0.768	0.399	0.706	0.227
	mr	0.627	0.912	0.817	0.468	0.638	0.299
up	rf	0.755	0.972	0.849	0.652	0.757	0.362
	svm	0.725	0.97	0.778	0.605	0.75	0.521
	xgb	0.729	0.975	0.862	0.685	0.753	0.368
	mr	0.694	0.951	0.808	0.616	0.67	0.428
smote	rf	0.68	0.972	0.82	0.616	0.688	0.304
	svm	0.739	0.969	0.811	0.638	0.752	0.524
	xgb	0.73	0.972	0.848	0.632	0.726	0.474
	mr	0.703	0.957	0.827	0.615	0.688	0.43
hybrid	rf	0.724	0.971	0.829	0.631	0.741	0.45
	svm	0.733	0.965	0.838	0.635	0.72	0.507
	xgb	0.729	0.973	0.823	0.615	0.729	0.503
	mr	0.699	0.956	0.821	0.606	0.675	0.437

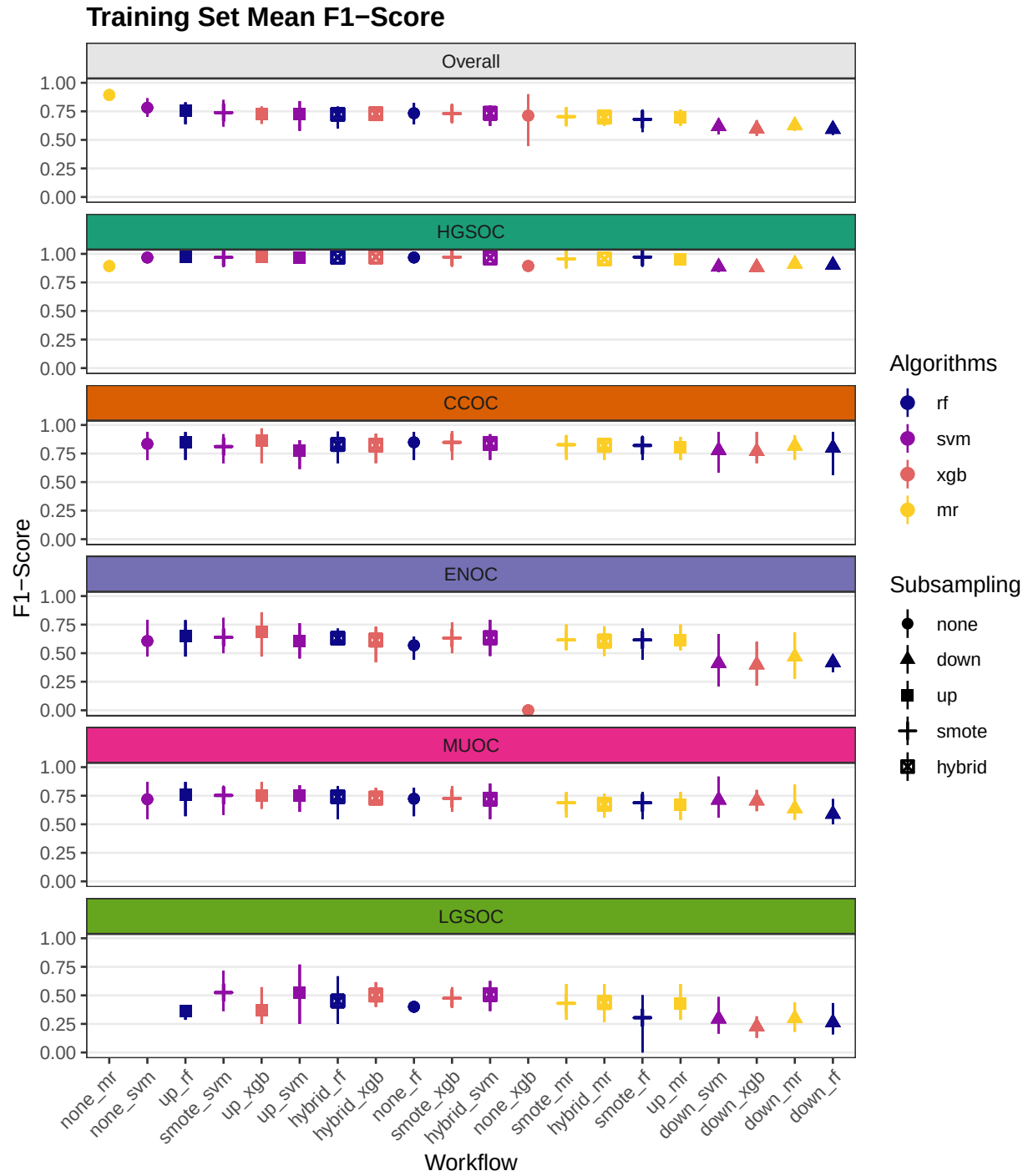


Figure 4.4: Training Set Mean F1-Score

4.1.5 Balanced Accuracy

Table 4.5: Training Set Mean Balanced Accuracy

Subsampling	Algorithms	Overall	Histotypes				
			HGSOC	CCOC	ENOC	MUOC	LGSOC
none	rf	0.791	0.879	0.895	0.741	0.858	0.583
	svm	0.781	0.882	0.879	0.778	0.868	0.5
	xgb	0.501	0.505	0.5	0.499	0.5	0.5
	mr	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5
down	rf	0.847	0.892	0.905	0.746	0.815	0.877
	svm	0.864	0.879	0.873	0.757	0.906	0.906
	xgb	0.851	0.88	0.899	0.731	0.906	0.84
	mr	0.867	0.905	0.909	0.775	0.87	0.874
up	rf	0.815	0.905	0.894	0.808	0.878	0.59
	svm	0.836	0.91	0.862	0.799	0.851	0.759
	xgb	0.846	0.928	0.906	0.83	0.893	0.671
	mr	0.877	0.929	0.914	0.816	0.88	0.845
smote	rf	0.808	0.911	0.872	0.797	0.865	0.595
	svm	0.862	0.923	0.875	0.826	0.869	0.814
	xgb	0.853	0.926	0.911	0.793	0.882	0.754
	mr	0.876	0.933	0.905	0.816	0.882	0.845
hybrid	rf	0.842	0.923	0.898	0.806	0.894	0.689
	svm	0.864	0.923	0.893	0.832	0.86	0.814
	xgb	0.858	0.936	0.902	0.79	0.882	0.778
	mr	0.876	0.932	0.899	0.815	0.864	0.868

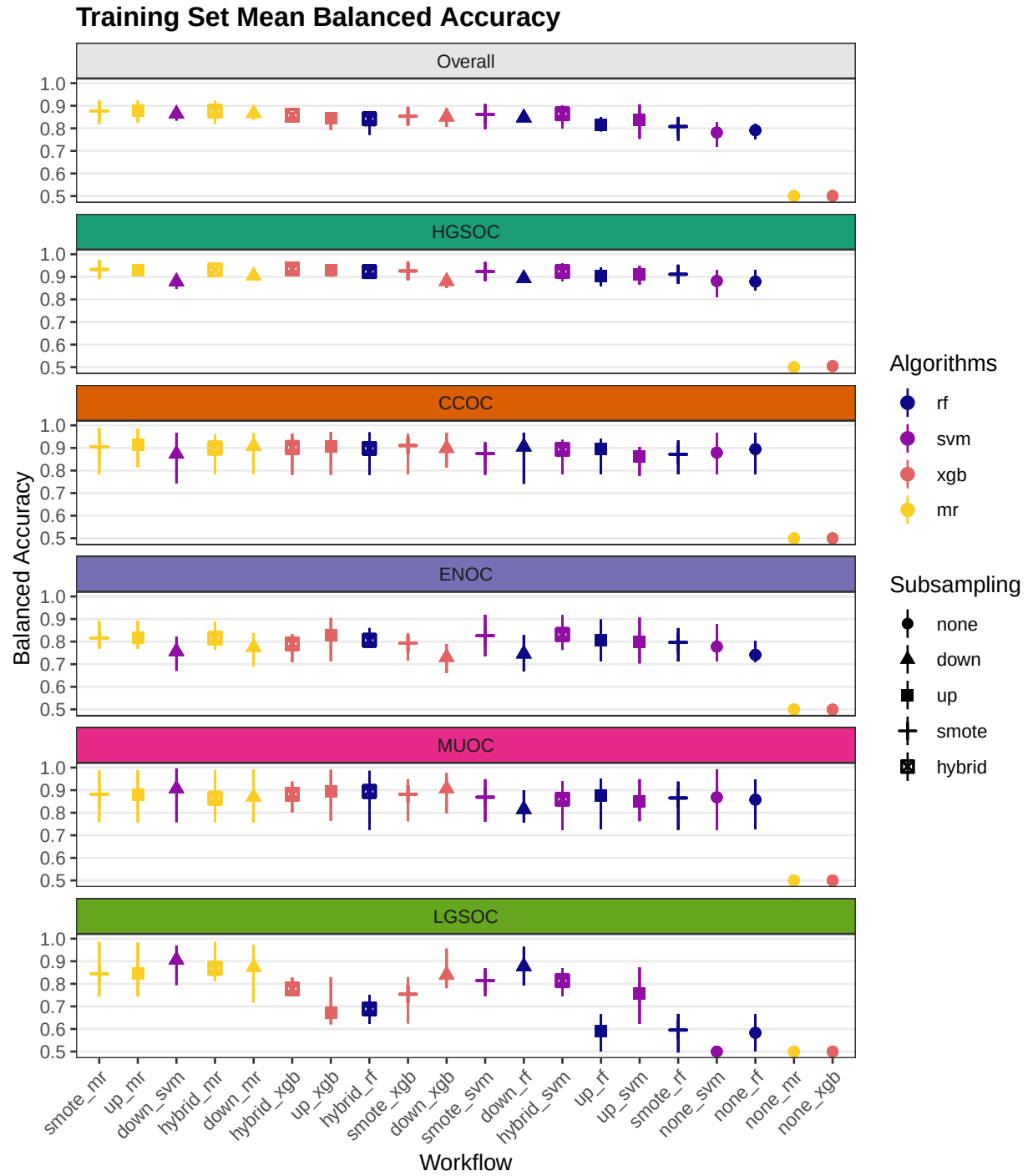


Figure 4.5: Training Set Mean Balanced Accuracy

4.1.6 Kappa

Table 4.6: Training Set Mean Kappa

Subsampling	Algorithms	Overall	Histotypes				
			HGSOC	CCOC	ENOC	MUOC	LGSOC
none	rf	0.744	0.822	0.84	0.545	0.711	0.237
	svm	0.741	0.818	0.825	0.583	0.706	0
	xgb	0.007	0.016	0	-0.003	0	0
	mr	0	0	0	0	0	0
down	rf	0.55	0.621	0.785	0.37	0.568	0.24
	svm	0.539	0.584	0.764	0.359	0.697	0.275
	xgb	0.526	0.578	0.752	0.348	0.69	0.204
	mr	0.592	0.654	0.805	0.424	0.618	0.279
up	rf	0.776	0.85	0.84	0.63	0.746	0.213
	svm	0.749	0.835	0.764	0.579	0.739	0.513
	xgb	0.795	0.871	0.854	0.666	0.741	0.36
	mr	0.705	0.775	0.795	0.588	0.652	0.415
smote	rf	0.756	0.853	0.81	0.591	0.673	0.299
	svm	0.761	0.839	0.8	0.614	0.741	0.516
	xgb	0.773	0.855	0.839	0.609	0.712	0.466
	mr	0.721	0.797	0.816	0.588	0.672	0.417
hybrid	rf	0.767	0.85	0.818	0.605	0.728	0.443
	svm	0.753	0.825	0.828	0.609	0.707	0.497
	xgb	0.77	0.863	0.812	0.59	0.715	0.494
	mr	0.713	0.793	0.81	0.577	0.658	0.424

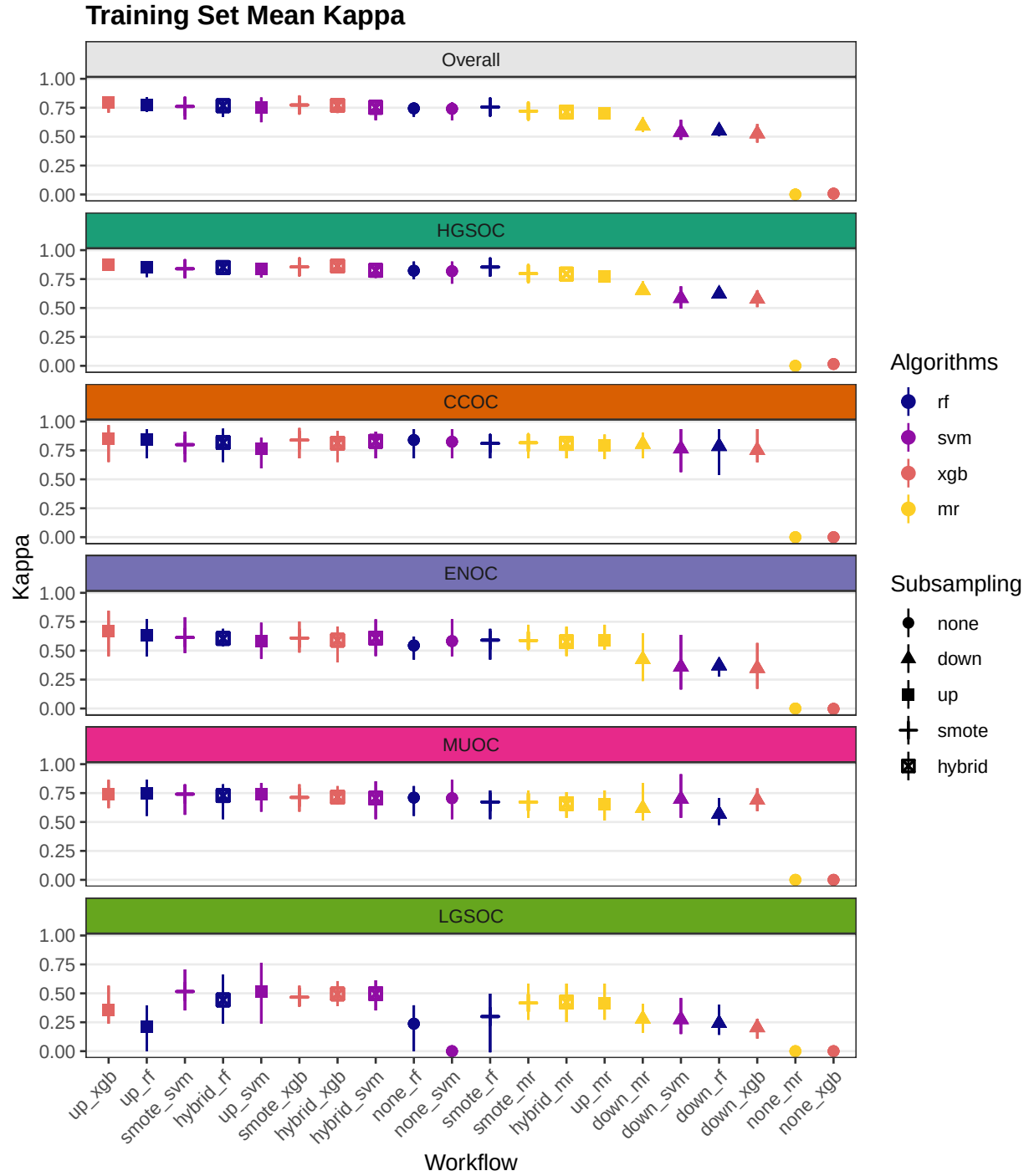


Figure 4.6: Training Set Mean Kappa

4.2 Rank Aggregation

Multi-step methods:

- **sequential:** sequential algorithm sequence of subsampling methods and algorithms used are:

- HGSOC vs. non-HGSOC using upsubsampling and XGBoost
 - CCOC vs. non-CCOC using no subsampling and random forest
 - ENOC vs. non-ENOC using no subsampling and support vector machine
 - MUOC vs. LGSOC using SMOTE subsampling and random forest
- **two_step**: two-step algorithm sequence of subsampling methods and algorithms used are:
 - HGSOC vs. non-HGSOC using upsampling and XGBoost
 - CCOC vs. ENOC vs. MUOC vs. LGSOC using SMOTE subsampling and support vector machine

We conduct rank aggregation using a two-stage nested approach:

1. First we rank aggregate the per-class metrics for F1-score, balanced accuracy and kappa.
2. Then we take the aggregated lists from the three metrics and perform a final rank aggregation.
3. The top workflows from the final rank aggregation are used for gene optimization in the confirmation set

4.2.1 Across Classes

4.2.1.1 F1-Score

Table 4.7: F1-Score Rank Aggregation Summary

Workflow	Rank	HGSOC	CCOC	ENOC	MUOC	LGSOC
sequential	1	0.977	0.868	0.86	0.966	0.91
two_step	2	0.977	0.899	0.755	0.788	0.733
up_xgb	3	0.975	0.862	0.685	0.753	0.368
up_rf	4	0.972	0.849	0.652	0.757	0.362
smote_svm	5	0.969	0.811	0.638	0.752	0.524
hybrid_svm	6	0.965	0.838	0.635	0.72	0.507
smote_xgb	7	0.972	0.848	0.632	0.726	0.474
hybrid_rf	8	0.971	0.829	0.631	0.741	0.45
up_svm	9	0.97	0.778	0.605	0.75	0.521
hybrid_xgb	10	0.973	0.823	0.615	0.729	0.503
none_rf	11	0.968	0.848	0.568	0.723	0.4
smote_mr	12	0.957	0.827	0.615	0.688	0.43
smote_rf	13	0.972	0.82	0.616	0.688	0.304
hybrid_mr	14	0.956	0.821	0.606	0.675	0.437
up_mr	15	0.951	0.808	0.616	0.67	0.428
down_mr	16	0.912	0.817	0.468	0.638	0.299
down_rf	17	0.901	0.799	0.419	0.589	0.262
down_svm	18	0.886	0.778	0.412	0.713	0.295
down_xgb	19	0.883	0.768	0.399	0.706	0.227

4.2.1.2 Balanced Accuracy

Table 4.8: Balanced Accuracy Rank Aggregation Summary

Workflow	Rank	HGSOC	CCOC	ENOC	MUOC	LGSOC
All	All	All	All	All	All	All
sequential	1	0.938	0.892	0.856	0.943	0.943
two_step	2	0.938	0.917	0.814	0.875	0.872
up_mlr	3	0.929	0.914	0.816	0.88	0.845
smote_mlr	4	0.933	0.905	0.816	0.882	0.845
up_xgb	5	0.928	0.906	0.83	0.893	0.671
smote_xgb	6	0.926	0.911	0.793	0.882	0.754
hybrid_mlr	7	0.932	0.899	0.815	0.864	0.868
hybrid_xgb	8	0.936	0.902	0.79	0.882	0.778
down_xgb	9	0.88	0.899	0.731	0.906	0.84
smote_svm	10	0.923	0.875	0.826	0.869	0.814
hybrid_rf	11	0.923	0.898	0.806	0.894	0.689
down_mlr	12	0.905	0.909	0.775	0.87	0.874
hybrid_svm	13	0.923	0.893	0.832	0.86	0.814
up_rf	14	0.905	0.894	0.808	0.878	0.59
smote_rf	15	0.911	0.872	0.797	0.865	0.595
down_rf	16	0.892	0.905	0.746	0.815	0.877
none_svm	17	0.882	0.879	0.778	0.868	0.5
down_svm	18	0.879	0.873	0.757	0.906	0.906
none_rf	19	0.879	0.895	0.741	0.858	0.583
up_svm	20	0.91	0.862	0.799	0.851	0.759
none_mlr	21	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5
none_xgb	22	0.505	0.5	0.499	0.5	0.5

4.2.1.3 Kappa

Table 4.9: Kappa Rank Aggregation Summary

Workflow	Rank	HGSOC	CCOC	ENOC	MUOC	LGSOC
sequential	1	0.879	0.808	0.712	0.877	0.877
two_step	2	0.879	0.85	0.635	0.716	0.718
up_xgb	3	0.871	0.854	0.666	0.741	0.36
up_rf	4	0.85	0.84	0.63	0.746	0.213
smote_svm	5	0.839	0.8	0.614	0.741	0.516
hybrid_rf	6	0.85	0.818	0.605	0.728	0.443
smote_xgb	7	0.855	0.839	0.609	0.712	0.466
hybrid_svm	8	0.825	0.828	0.609	0.707	0.497
up_svm	9	0.835	0.764	0.579	0.739	0.513
hybrid_xgb	10	0.863	0.812	0.59	0.715	0.494
smote_rf	11	0.853	0.81	0.591	0.673	0.299
smote_mr	12	0.797	0.816	0.588	0.672	0.417
none_svm	13	0.818	0.825	0.583	0.706	0
none_rf	14	0.822	0.84	0.545	0.711	0.237
hybrid_mr	15	0.793	0.81	0.577	0.658	0.424
up_mr	16	0.775	0.795	0.588	0.652	0.415
down_mr	17	0.654	0.805	0.424	0.618	0.279
down_rf	18	0.621	0.785	0.37	0.568	0.24
down_svm	19	0.584	0.764	0.359	0.697	0.275
down_xgb	20	0.578	0.752	0.348	0.69	0.204
none_mr	21	0	0	0	0	0
none_xgb	22	0.016	0	-0.003	0	0

4.2.2 Across Metrics

Table 4.10: Rank Aggregation Comparison of Metrics Used in Training Set

Rank	F1	Balanced Accuracy	Kappa
1	sequential	sequential	sequential
2	two_step	two_step	two_step
3	up_xgb	up_mr	up_xgb
4	up_rf	smote_mr	up_rf
5	smote_svm	up_xgb	smote_svm
6	hybrid_svm	smote_xgb	hybrid_rf
7	smote_xgb	hybrid_mr	smote_xgb
8	hybrid_rf	hybrid_xgb	hybrid_svm
9	up_svm	down_xgb	up_svm
10	hybrid_xgb	smote_svm	hybrid_xgb
11	none_rf	hybrid_rf	smote_rf
12	smote_mr	down_mr	smote_mr
13	smote_rf	hybrid_svm	none_svm
14	hybrid_mr	up_rf	none_rf
15	up_mr	smote_rf	hybrid_mr
16	down_mr	down_rf	up_mr
17	down_rf	none_svm	down_mr
18	down_svm	down_svm	down_rf
19	down_xgb	none_rf	down_svm
20	NA	up_svm	down_xgb
21	NA	none_mr	none_mr
22	NA	none_xgb	none_xgb

Table 4.11: Top 5 Workflows from Final Rank Aggregation

Rank	Workflow
1	sequential
2	two_step
3	up_xgb
4	up_rf
5	smote_svm

4.2.3 Top Workflows

We look at the per-class evaluation metrics of the top 5 workflows.

Table 4.12: Top Workflow Per-Class Evaluation Metrics

Metric	Workflow	Histotypes				
		HGSOC	CCOC	ENOC	MUOC	LGSOC
Accuracy	Sequential	0.963 (0.956, 0.968)	0.917 (0.896, 0.958)	0.856 (0.774, 0.909)	0.951 (0.882, 1)	0.951 (0.882, 1)
	2-STEP	0.963 (0.956, 0.968)	0.934 (0.896, 0.958)	0.839 (0.729, 0.896)	0.892 (0.812, 0.96)	0.971 (0.938, 1)
	Up-XGB	0.96 (0.944, 0.976)	0.985 (0.968, 0.996)	0.963 (0.956, 0.976)	0.977 (0.968, 0.988)	0.981 (0.976, 0.988)
	Up-RF	0.955 (0.92, 0.976)	0.983 (0.972, 0.992)	0.959 (0.948, 0.972)	0.979 (0.964, 0.988)	0.982 (0.968, 0.988)
	SMOTE-SVM	0.95 (0.936, 0.968)	0.979 (0.968, 0.988)	0.954 (0.94, 0.964)	0.978 (0.96, 0.984)	0.981 (0.972, 0.984)
Sensitivity	Sequential	0.978 (0.966, 0.99)	0.814 (0.75, 0.882)	0.865 (0.812, 0.941)	0.965 (0.909, 1)	0.92 (0.6, 1)
	2-STEP	0.978 (0.966, 0.99)	0.866 (0.824, 0.933)	0.735 (0.556, 0.824)	0.842 (0.75, 0.923)	0.767 (0, 1)
	Up-XGB	0.981 (0.976, 0.986)	0.817 (0.571, 0.941)	0.679 (0.444, 0.818)	0.8 (0.538, 1)	0.35 (0.25, 0.667)
	Up-RF	0.988 (0.979, 0.995)	0.793 (0.571, 0.882)	0.635 (0.444, 0.812)	0.766 (0.462, 0.909)	0.183 (0, 0.333)
	SMOTE-SVM	0.966 (0.955, 0.977)	0.757 (0.571, 0.85)	0.681 (0.5, 0.864)	0.748 (0.538, 0.909)	0.642 (0.5, 0.75)
Specificity	Sequential	0.897 (0.875, 0.918)	0.969 (0.938, 1)	0.847 (0.733, 0.875)	0.92 (0.6, 1)	0.965 (0.909, 1)
	2-STEP	0.897 (0.875, 0.918)	0.969 (0.935, 1)	0.893 (0.833, 0.935)	0.908 (0.833, 0.973)	0.977 (0.953, 1)
	Up-XGB	0.875 (0.826, 0.919)	0.996 (0.992, 1)	0.981 (0.97, 0.991)	0.986 (0.979, 0.992)	0.993 (0.984, 1)
	Up-RF	0.822 (0.738, 0.892)	0.996 (0.992, 1)	0.98 (0.966, 0.987)	0.989 (0.983, 0.996)	0.997 (0.988, 1)
	SMOTE-SVM	0.88 (0.804, 0.919)	0.993 (0.987, 1)	0.971 (0.962, 0.975)	0.989 (0.983, 0.996)	0.987 (0.976, 0.996)
F1-Score	Sequential	0.977 (0.973, 0.98)	0.868 (0.828, 0.933)	0.86 (0.788, 0.914)	0.966 (0.923, 1)	0.91 (0.75, 1)
	2-STEP	0.977 (0.973, 0.98)	0.899 (0.848, 0.933)	0.755 (0.606, 0.848)	0.788 (0.667, 0.923)	0.733 (0, 1)
	Up-XGB	0.975 (0.964, 0.986)	0.862 (0.667, 0.97)	0.685 (0.471, 0.857)	0.753 (0.636, 0.87)	0.368 (0.25, 0.571)
	Up-RF	0.972 (0.949, 0.986)	0.849 (0.696, 0.938)	0.652 (0.471, 0.788)	0.757 (0.571, 0.87)	0.362 (0.286, 0.4)
	SMOTE-SVM	0.969 (0.96, 0.981)	0.811 (0.667, 0.919)	0.638 (0.5, 0.809)	0.752 (0.583, 0.833)	0.524 (0.364, 0.714)
Balanced Accuracy	Sequential	0.938 (0.928, 0.947)	0.892 (0.859, 0.938)	0.856 (0.773, 0.908)	0.943 (0.8, 1)	0.943 (0.8, 1)
	2-STEP	0.938 (0.928, 0.947)	0.917 (0.88, 0.952)	0.814 (0.694, 0.88)	0.875 (0.792, 0.948)	0.872 (0.479, 1)
	Up-XGB	0.928 (0.901, 0.952)	0.906 (0.781, 0.971)	0.83 (0.714, 0.905)	0.893 (0.765, 0.99)	0.671 (0.621, 0.829)
	Up-RF	0.905 (0.858, 0.941)	0.894 (0.784, 0.941)	0.808 (0.714, 0.898)	0.878 (0.727, 0.95)	0.59 (0.5, 0.665)
	SMOTE-SVM	0.923 (0.885, 0.948)	0.875 (0.781, 0.925)	0.826 (0.735, 0.919)	0.869 (0.761, 0.948)	0.814 (0.746, 0.869)
Kappa	Sequential	0.879 (0.862, 0.895)	0.808 (0.754, 0.903)	0.712 (0.547, 0.818)	0.877 (0.679, 1)	0.877 (0.679, 1)
	2-STEP	0.879 (0.862, 0.895)	0.85 (0.769, 0.903)	0.635 (0.402, 0.769)	0.716 (0.538, 0.896)	0.718 (-0.029, 1)
	Up-XGB	0.871 (0.822, 0.905)	0.854 (0.65, 0.968)	0.666 (0.452, 0.844)	0.741 (0.62, 0.863)	0.36 (0.239, 0.566)
	Up-RF	0.85 (0.768, 0.903)	0.84 (0.682, 0.933)	0.63 (0.452, 0.773)	0.746 (0.554, 0.863)	0.213 (0, 0.396)
	SMOTE-SVM	0.839 (0.783, 0.876)	0.8 (0.65, 0.913)	0.614 (0.48, 0.789)	0.741 (0.563, 0.825)	0.516 (0.352, 0.706)

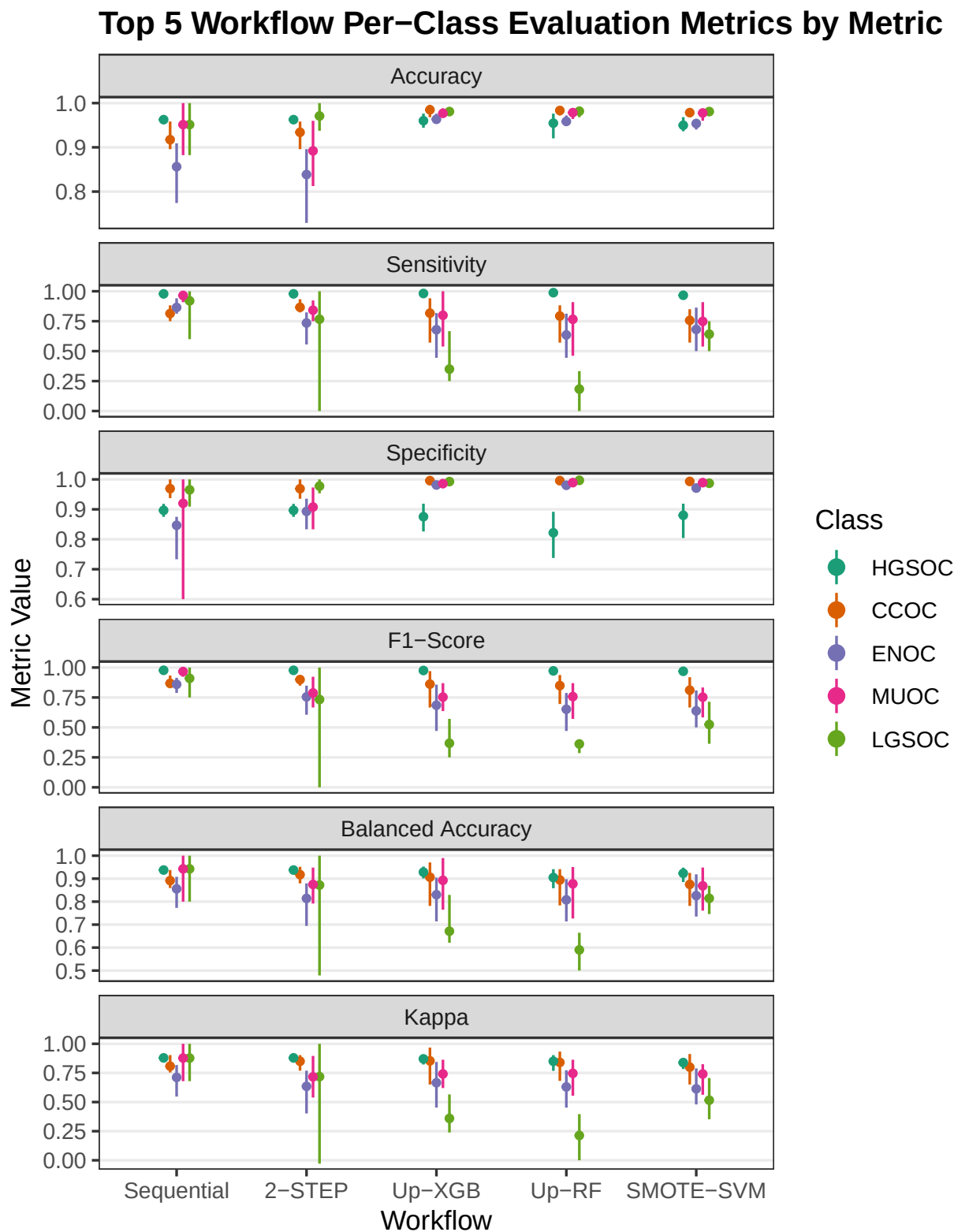


Figure 4.7: Top 5 Workflow Per-Class Evaluation Metrics by Metric

Table 4.13: Top Workflow Per-Class Evaluation Metrics and Ranks

Workflow	Rank	HGSOC	CCOC	ENOC	MUOC	LGSOC
F1-Score						
Sequential	1	0.977	0.868	0.860	0.966	0.910
2-STEP	2	0.977	0.899	0.755	0.788	0.733
Up-XGB	3	0.975	0.862	0.685	0.753	0.368
Up-RF	4	0.972	0.849	0.652	0.757	0.362
SMOTE-SVM	5	0.969	0.811	0.638	0.752	0.524
Balanced Accuracy						
Sequential	1	0.938	0.892	0.856	0.943	0.943
2-STEP	2	0.938	0.917	0.814	0.875	0.872
Up-XGB	5	0.928	0.906	0.830	0.893	0.671
SMOTE-SVM	10	0.923	0.875	0.826	0.869	0.814
Up-RF	14	0.905	0.894	0.808	0.878	0.590
Kappa						
Sequential	1	0.879	0.808	0.712	0.877	0.877
2-STEP	2	0.879	0.850	0.635	0.716	0.718
Up-XGB	3	0.871	0.854	0.666	0.741	0.360
Up-RF	4	0.850	0.840	0.630	0.746	0.213
SMOTE-SVM	5	0.839	0.800	0.614	0.741	0.516

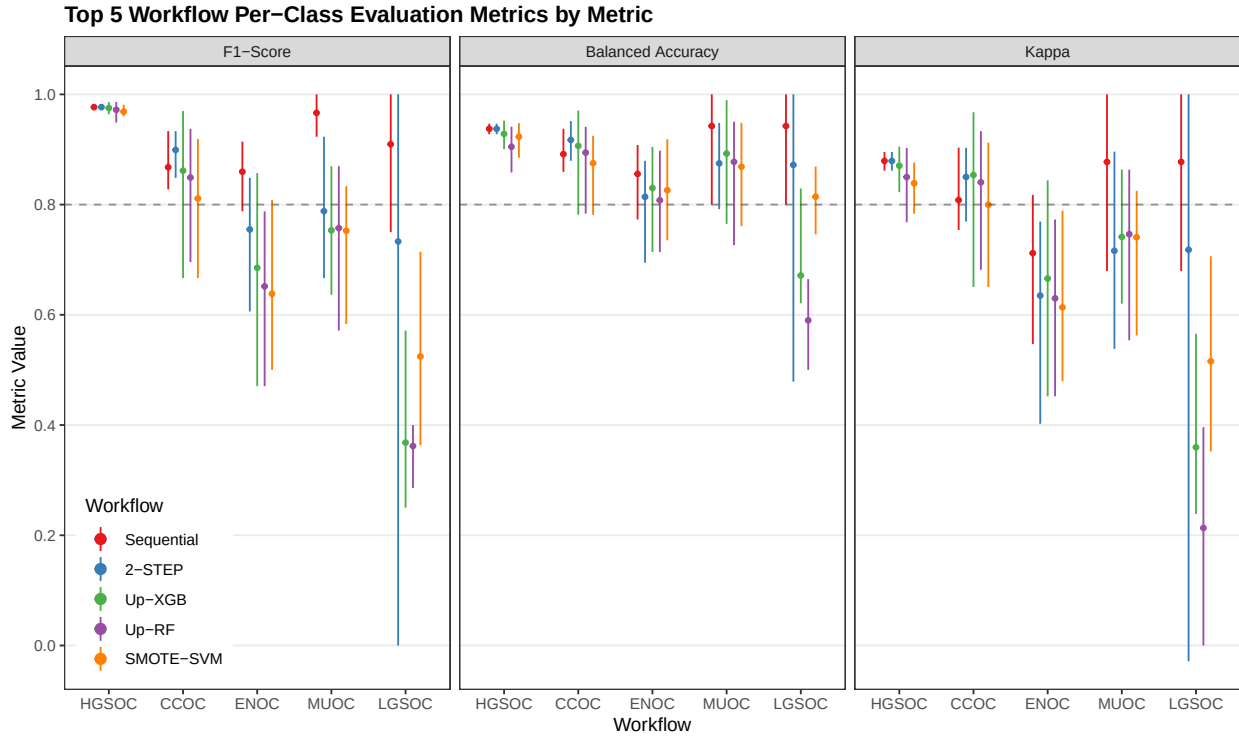


Figure 4.8: Top 5 Workflow Per-Class Evaluation Metrics by Metric

Misclassified cases from a previous step of the sequence of classifiers are not included in subsequent steps of the training set CV folds. Thus, we cannot piece together the test set predictions from the sequential and two-step algorithms to obtain overall metrics.

4.3 Confirmation Set

Now we'd like to see how our best five workflows perform in the confirmation set. The class-specific F1-scores will be used. The top performing method will be selected for gene optimization.

Table 4.14: Evaluation Metrics on Confirmation Set Models

Method	Metric	Overall	Histotypes				
			HGSOC	CCOC	ENOC	MUOC	LGSOC
Sequential	Accuracy	0.830	0.860	0.977	0.882	0.969	0.974
	Sensitivity	0.592	0.950	0.847	0.486	0.593	0.083
	Specificity	0.923	0.683	0.993	0.961	0.985	0.990
	F1-Score	0.618	0.900	0.891	0.578	0.615	0.105
	Balanced Accuracy	0.757	0.817	0.920	0.723	0.789	0.537
	Kappa	0.648	0.670	0.877	0.512	0.599	0.093
2-STEP	Accuracy	0.833	0.860	0.970	0.889	0.978	0.969
	Sensitivity	0.608	0.950	0.861	0.477	0.667	0.083
	Specificity	0.923	0.683	0.984	0.972	0.992	0.986
	F1-Score	0.633	0.900	0.867	0.590	0.720	0.091
	Balanced Accuracy	0.766	0.817	0.923	0.724	0.829	0.535
	Kappa	0.655	0.670	0.850	0.530	0.709	0.075
Up-XGB	Accuracy	0.844	0.868	0.970	0.896	0.980	0.975
	Sensitivity	0.658	0.958	0.875	0.467	0.741	0.250
	Specificity	0.927	0.693	0.982	0.981	0.990	0.989
	F1-Score	0.680	0.905	0.869	0.599	0.755	0.273
	Balanced Accuracy	0.793	0.825	0.929	0.724	0.865	0.619
	Kappa	0.678	0.688	0.852	0.544	0.744	0.260
Up-RF	Accuracy	0.835	0.857	0.975	0.883	0.974	0.981
	Sensitivity	0.613	0.972	0.875	0.383	0.667	0.167
	Specificity	0.918	0.633	0.988	0.983	0.987	0.997
	F1-Score	0.648	0.900	0.887	0.522	0.679	0.250
	Balanced Accuracy	0.765	0.802	0.931	0.683	0.827	0.582
	Kappa	0.646	0.654	0.873	0.466	0.665	0.243
SMOTE-SVM	Accuracy	0.827	0.866	0.958	0.888	0.972	0.970
	Sensitivity	0.650	0.939	0.861	0.477	0.556	0.417
	Specificity	0.927	0.725	0.970	0.970	0.990	0.981
	F1-Score	0.656	0.902	0.821	0.586	0.625	0.345
	Balanced Accuracy	0.788	0.832	0.916	0.723	0.773	0.699
	Kappa	0.651	0.690	0.797	0.525	0.611	0.330

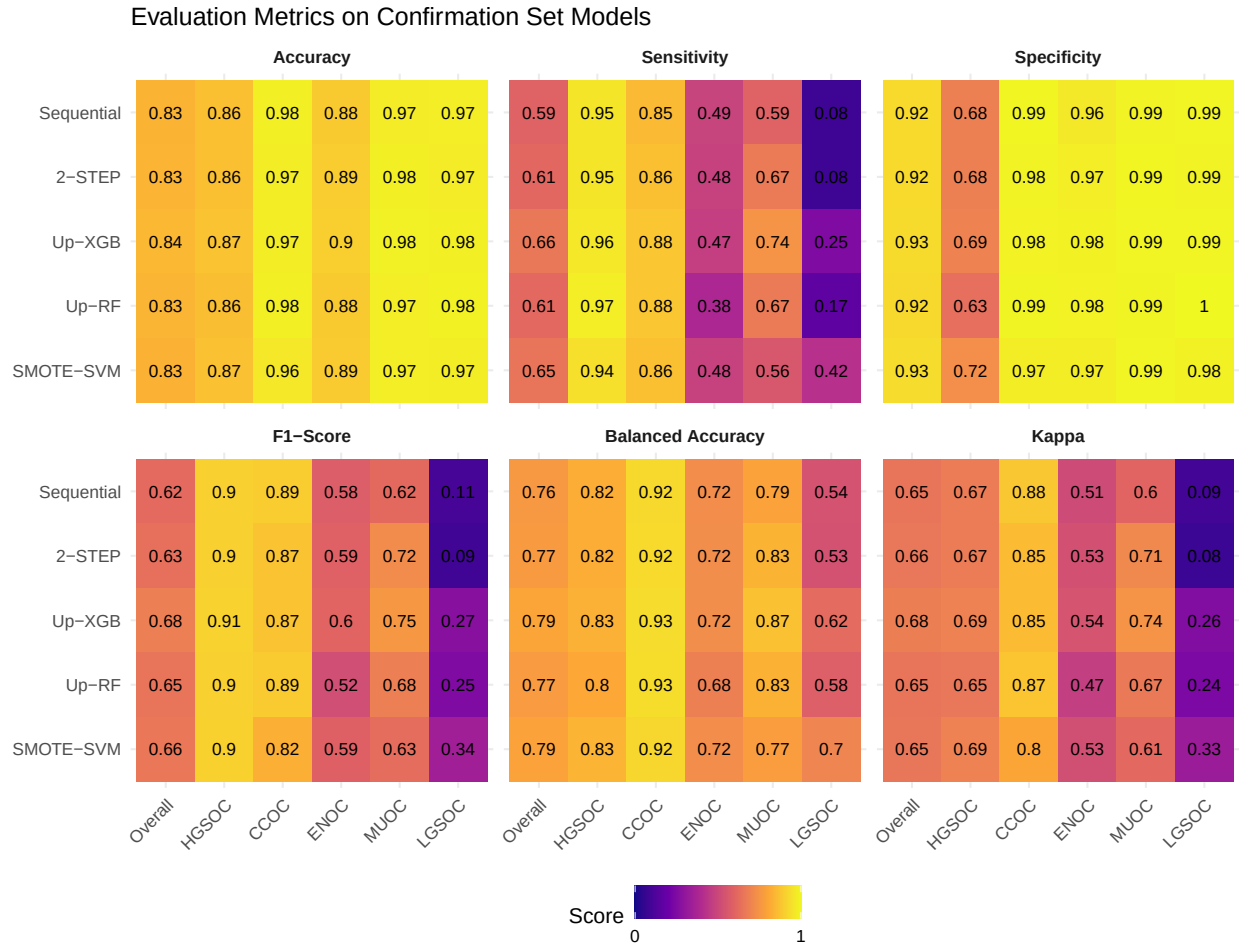


Figure 4.9: Evaluation Metrics on Confirmation Set Models

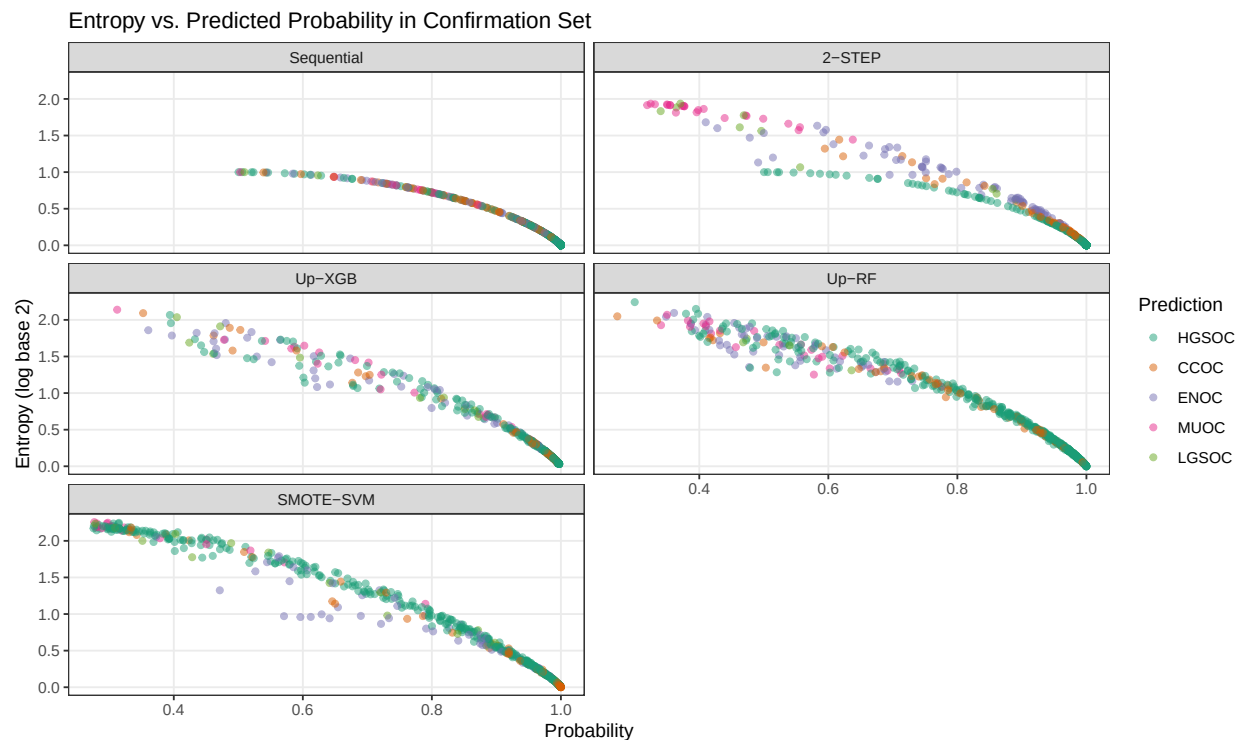


Figure 4.10: Entropy vs. Predicted Probability in Confirmation Set

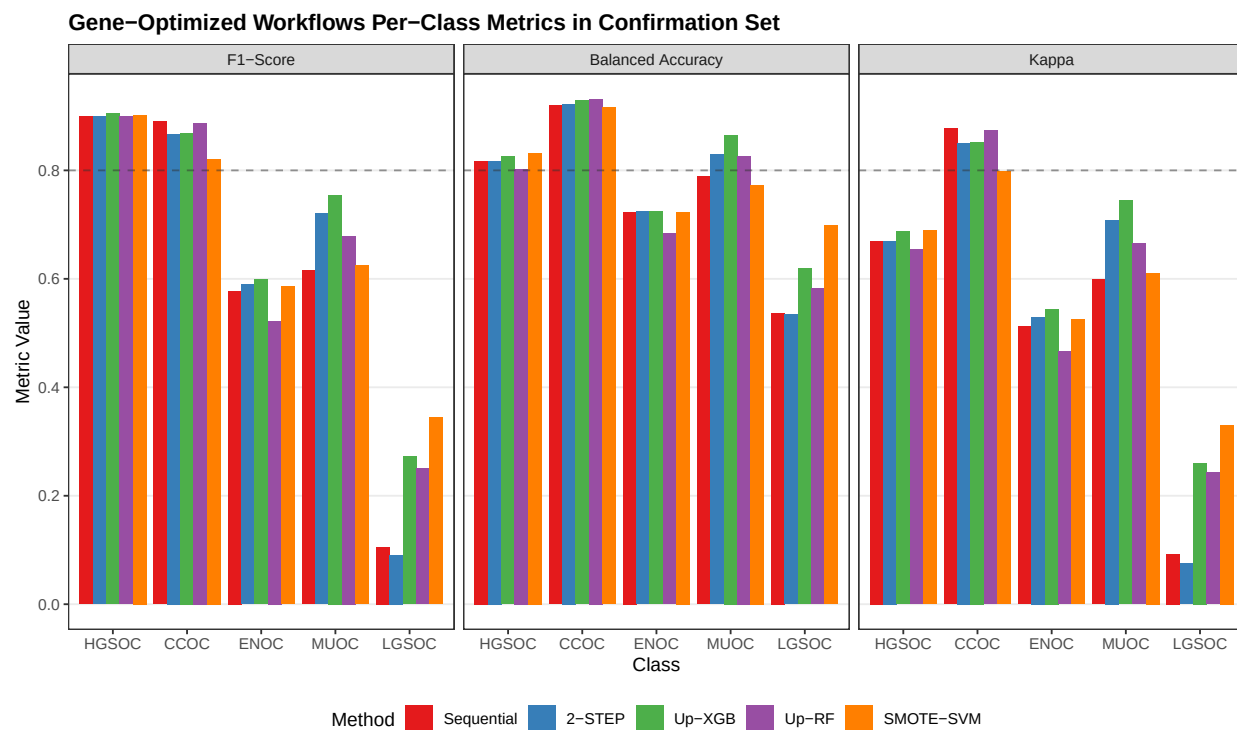


Figure 4.11: Gene Optimized Workflows Per-Class Metrics in Confirmation Set

Confusion Matrices for Confirmation Set Models

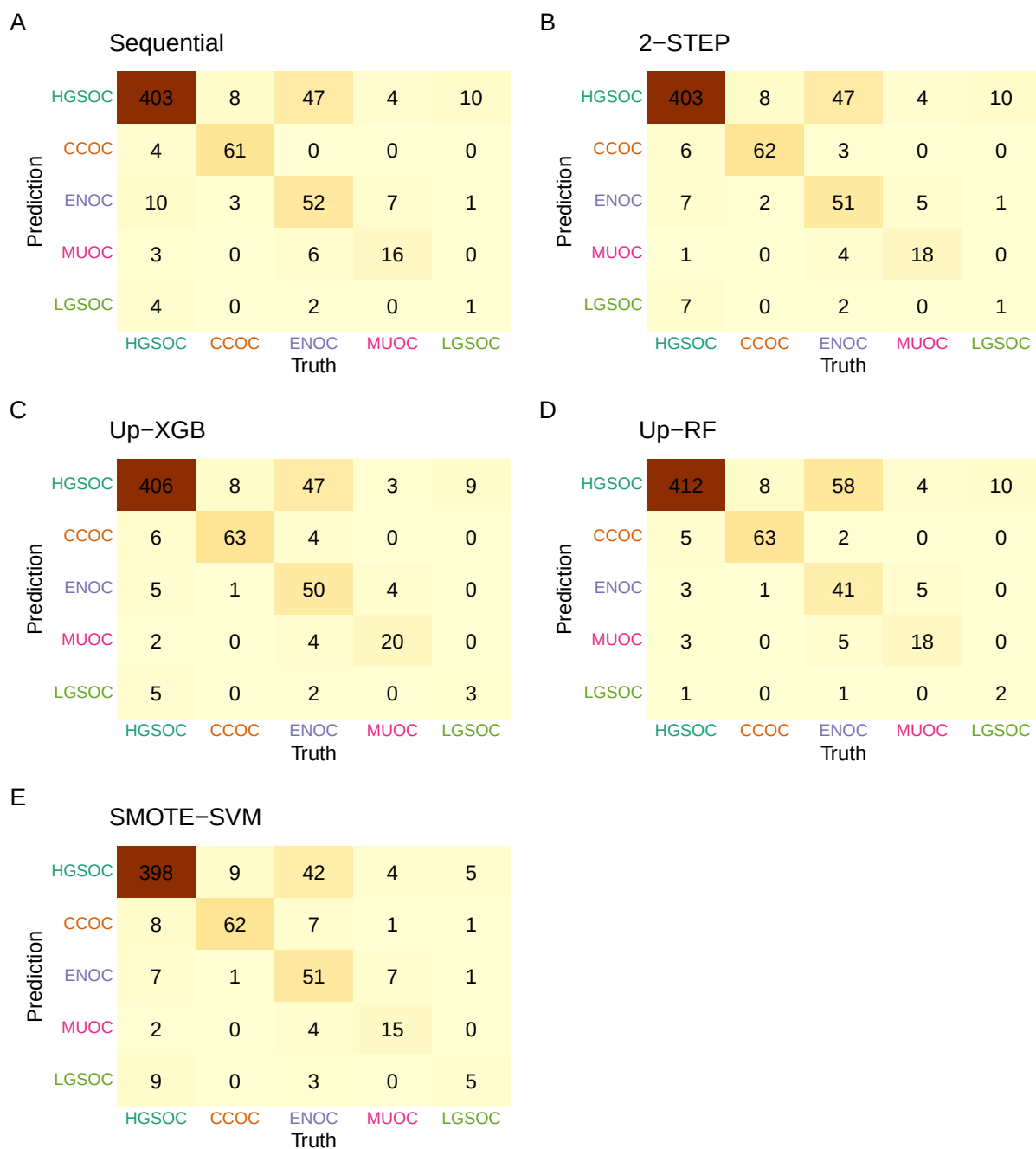


Figure 4.12: Confusion Matrices for Confirmation Set Models

4.3.1 Sequential

ROC Curves for Sequential Model in Confirmation Set

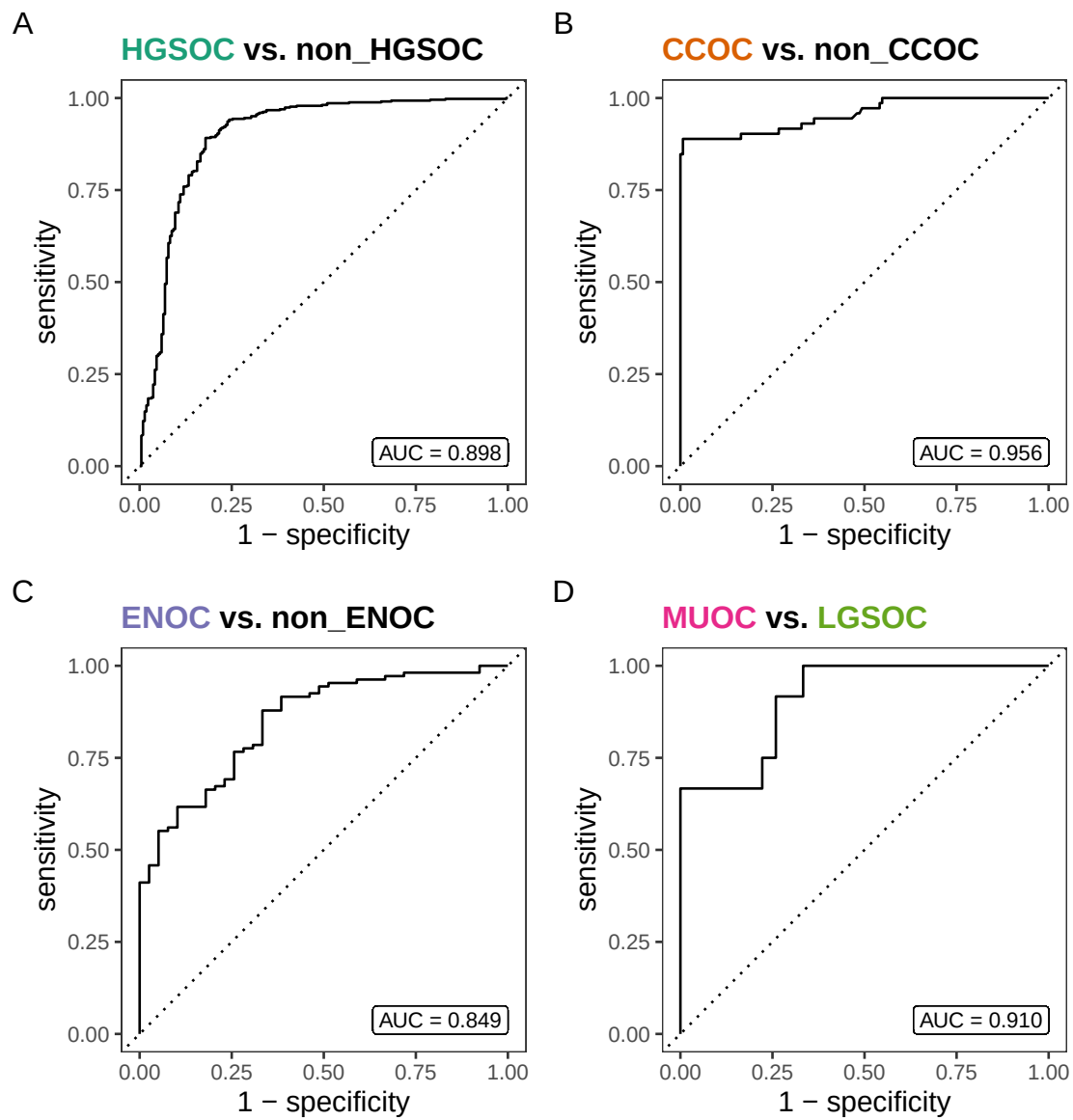


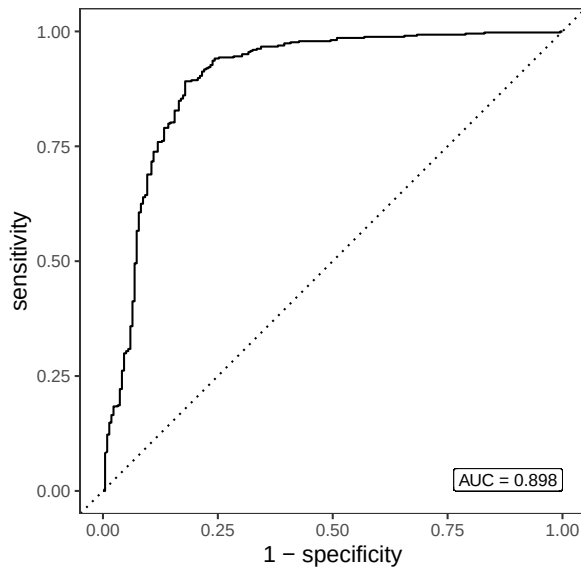
Figure 4.13: ROC Curves for Sequential Model in Confirmation Set

4.3.2 2-STEP

ROC Curves for 2-STEP Model in Confirmation Set

A

HGSOC vs. non_HGSOC



B

CCOC vs. ENOC vs. MUOC vs. LGSOC

AUC = 0.879

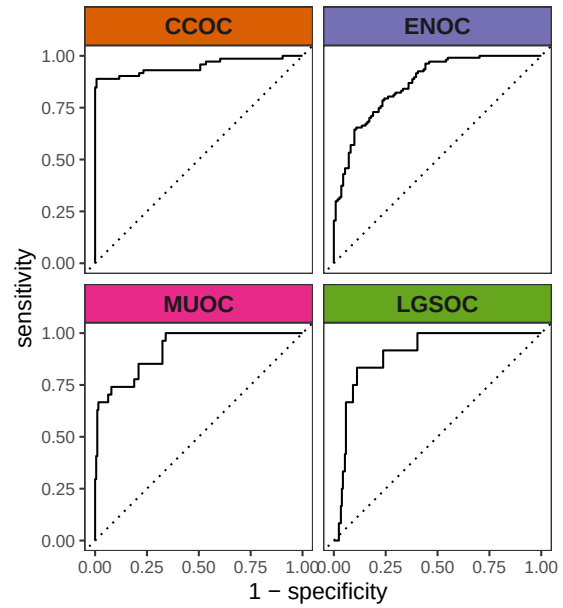


Figure 4.14: ROC Curves for 2-STEP Model in Confirmation Set

4.3.3 Up-XGB

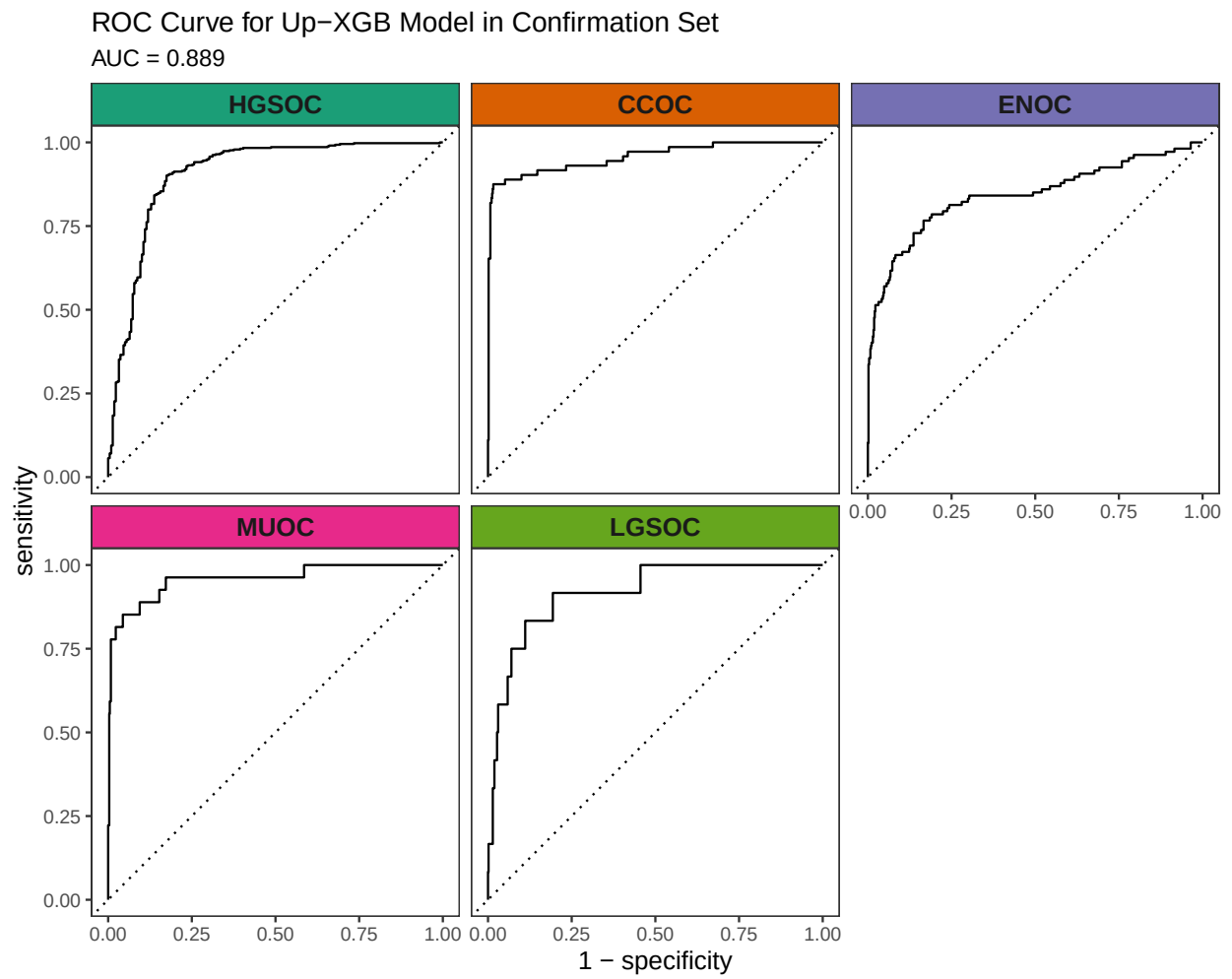


Figure 4.15: ROC Curve for Up-XGB Model in Confirmation Set

4.3.4 Up-RF

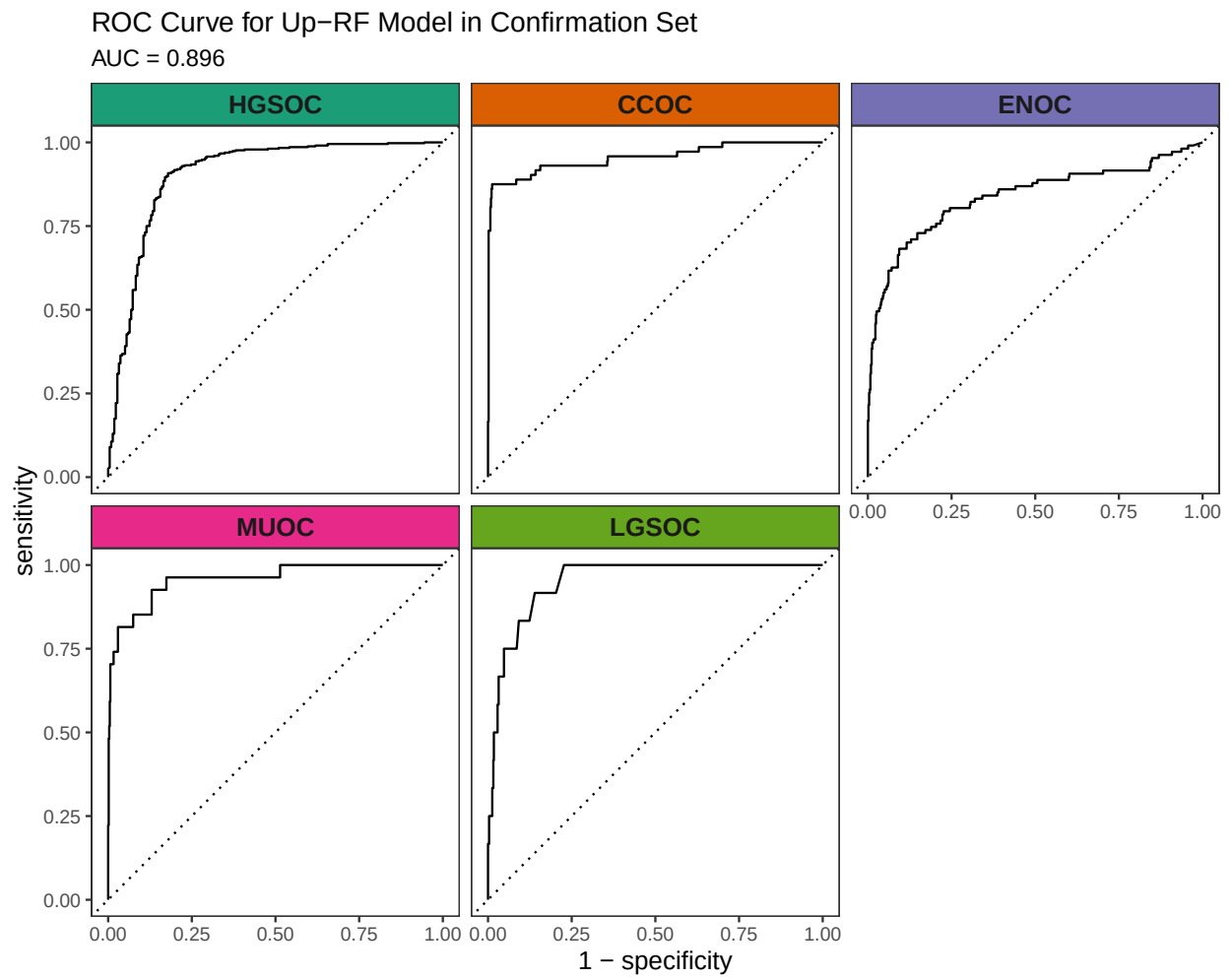


Figure 4.16: ROC Curve for Up-RF Model in Confirmation Set

4.3.5 SMOTE-SVM

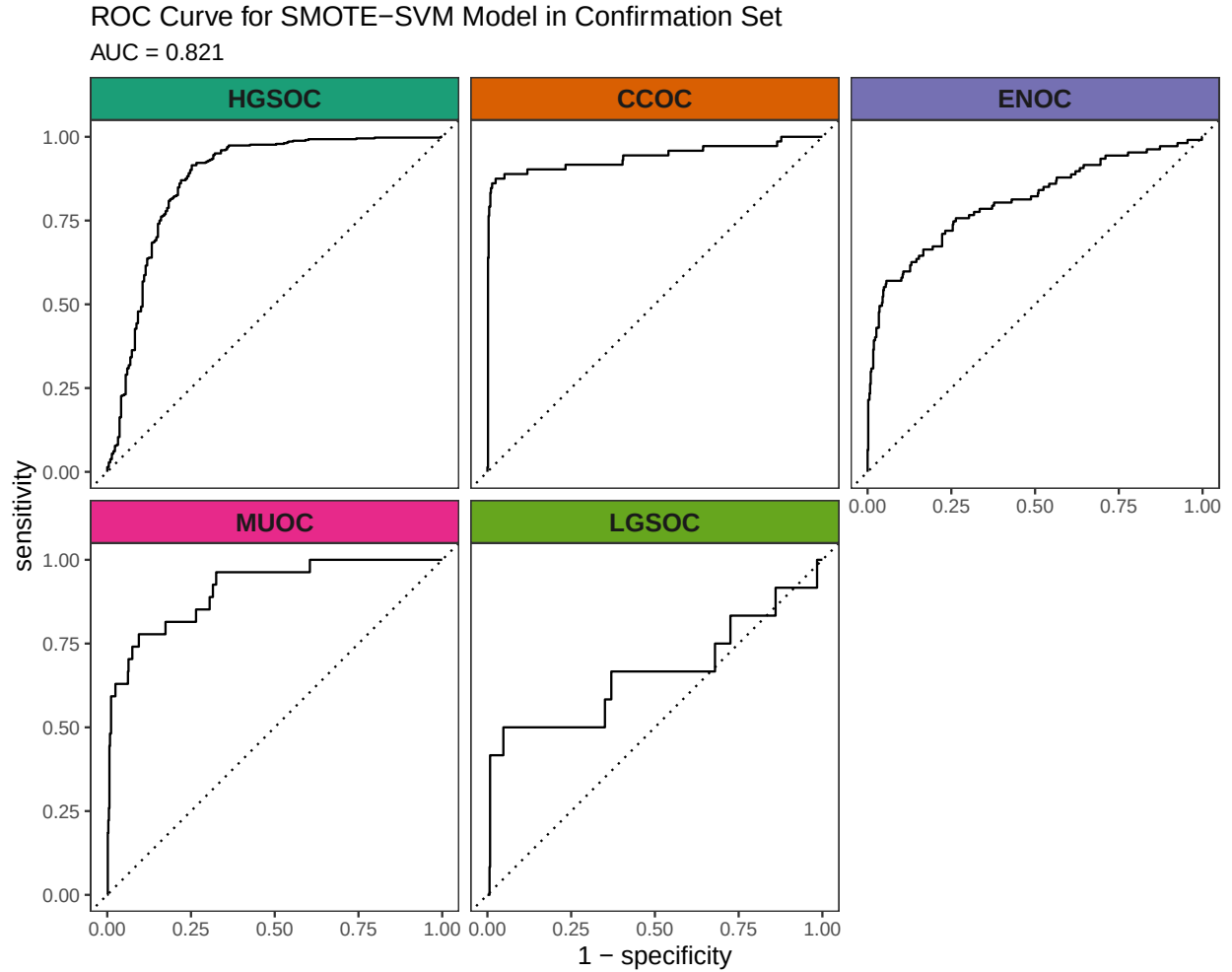


Figure 4.17: ROC Curve for SMOTE-SVM Model in Confirmation Set

4.4 Gene Optimization

From Figure 4.9, we see that although Up-XGB has the highest overall evaluation metric scores, SMOTE-SVM is better at predicting the rarest histotype LGSOC. Thus we choose both of these two workflows for gene optimization in the confirmation set. The optimal number of genes is determined by the fewest genes needed to achieve an average F1-Score across classes above 0.7, including the overall metric in the average. We use an F1-score that is averaged across cross-validation folds (5) and class groups (6: Overall, HGSOc, CCOC, ENOC, MUOC, LGSOC) to compare performance between different number of genes selected.

4.4.1 SMOTE-SVM

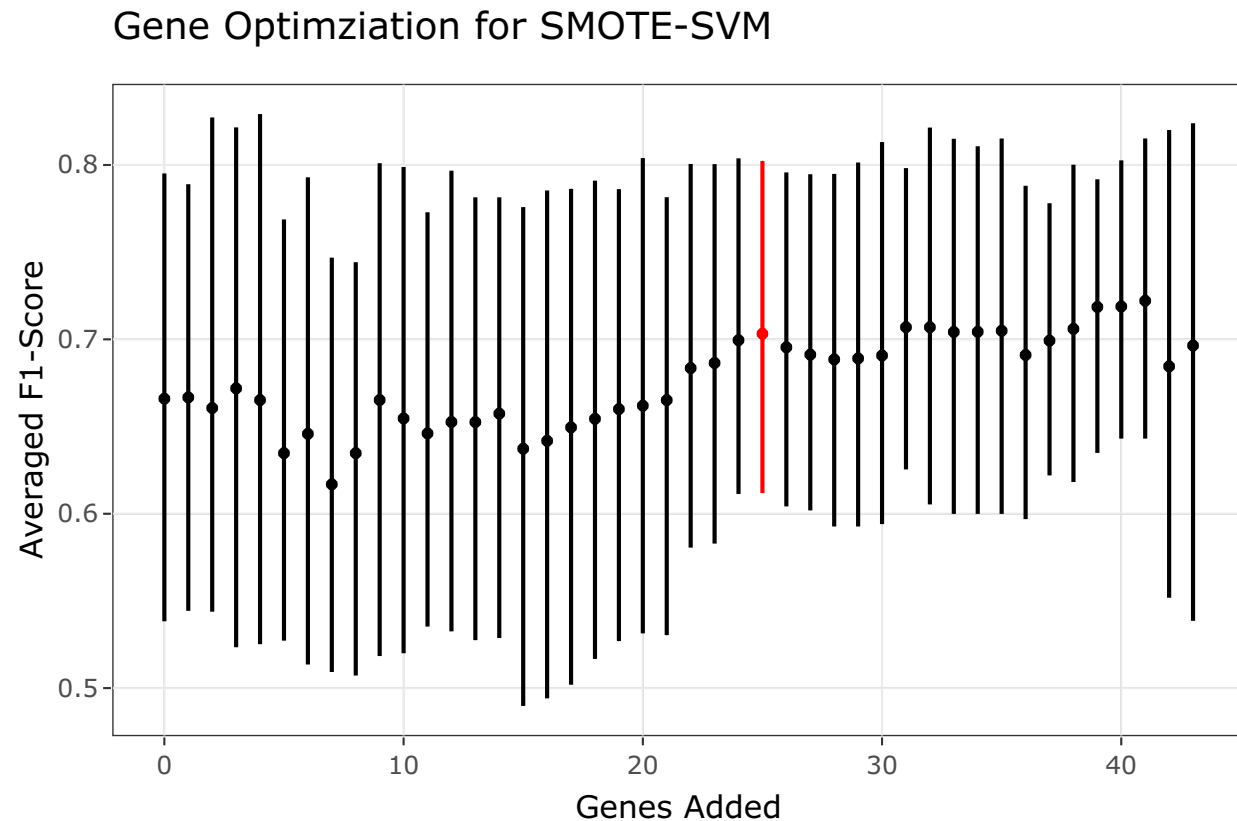


Figure 4.18: Gene Optimization for SMOTE-SVM Classifier using Averaged F1-Score

In the SMOTE-SVM classifier, the optimal number of genes is highlighted in red in Figure 4.18. Hence the optimal number of total genes used will be $n=28+25=53$.

The gene profile of the optimal set of genes used is displayed in Table 4.15. Base genes in the PrOTYPE and SPOT sets are annotated with green circles, and the added genes are annotated with yellow circles. The added genes are: EGFL6, IGJ, IGKC, TP53, DKK4, MUC5B, SLC3A1, MAP1LC3A, IGFBP1, CPNE8, SERPINA5, SCGB1D2, STC1, EPAS1, BRCA1, KGFLP2, SENP8, BCL2, PBX1, KLK7, C10orf116, LIN28B, LGALS4, ADCYAP1R1 and IL6. Unused genes are annotated with red crosses.

Table 4.15: Gene Profile of Optimal Set in SMOTE-SVM Workflow

Set	Genes	PrOTYPE	SPOT	Optimal Set	Candidate Rank
	COL11A1	v		(*)	
	CD74	v		(*)	
	CD2	v		(*)	
	TIMP3	v		(*)	
	LUM	v		(*)	

Base	CYTIP	v	(*)	
	COL3A1	v	(*)	
	THBS2	v	(*)	
	TCF7L1	v	v	(*)
	HMGA2	v		(*)
	FN1	v		(*)
	POSTN	v		(*)
	COL1A2	v		(*)
	COL5A2	v		(*)
	PDZK1IP1	v		(*)
	FBN1	v		(*)
	HIF1A		v	(*)
	CXCL10		v	(*)
	DUSP4		v	(*)
	SOX17		v	(*)
	MITF		v	(*)
	CDKN3		v	(*)
	BRCA2		v	(*)
	CEACAM5		v	(*)
	ANXA4		v	(*)
	SERPINE1		v	(*)
	CRABP2		v	(*)
	DNAJC9		v	(*)
	EGFL6			(*) 1
	IGJ			(*) 2
	IGKC			(*) 3
	TP53			(*) 4
	DKK4			(*) 5
	MUC5B			(*) 6
	SLC3A1			(*) 7
	MAP1LC3A			(*) 8
	IGFBP1			(*) 9
	CPNE8			(*) 10
	SERPINA5			(*) 11

Candidates	SCGB1D2	(*)	12
	STC1	(*)	13
	EPAS1	(*)	14
	BRCA1	(*)	15
	KGFLP2	(*)	16
	SENP8	(*)	17
	BCL2	(*)	18
	PBX1	(*)	19
	KLK7	(*)	20
	C10orf116	(*)	21
	LIN28B	(*)	22
	LGALS4	(*)	23
	ADCYAP1R1	(*)	24
	IL6	(*)	25
	ZBED1	(x)	26
	WT1	(x)	27
	TFF1	(x)	28
	GCNT3	(x)	29
	HNF1B	(x)	30
	TFF3	(x)	31
	CYP4B1	(x)	32
	CYP2C18	(x)	33
	TSPAN8	(x)	34
	FUT3	(x)	35
	MET	(x)	36
	ATP5G3	(x)	37
	SEMA6A	(x)	38
	GPR64	(x)	39
	PAX8	(x)	40
	C1orf173	(x)	41
	GAD1	(x)	42
	CAPN2	(x)	43

4.4.2 Up-XGB

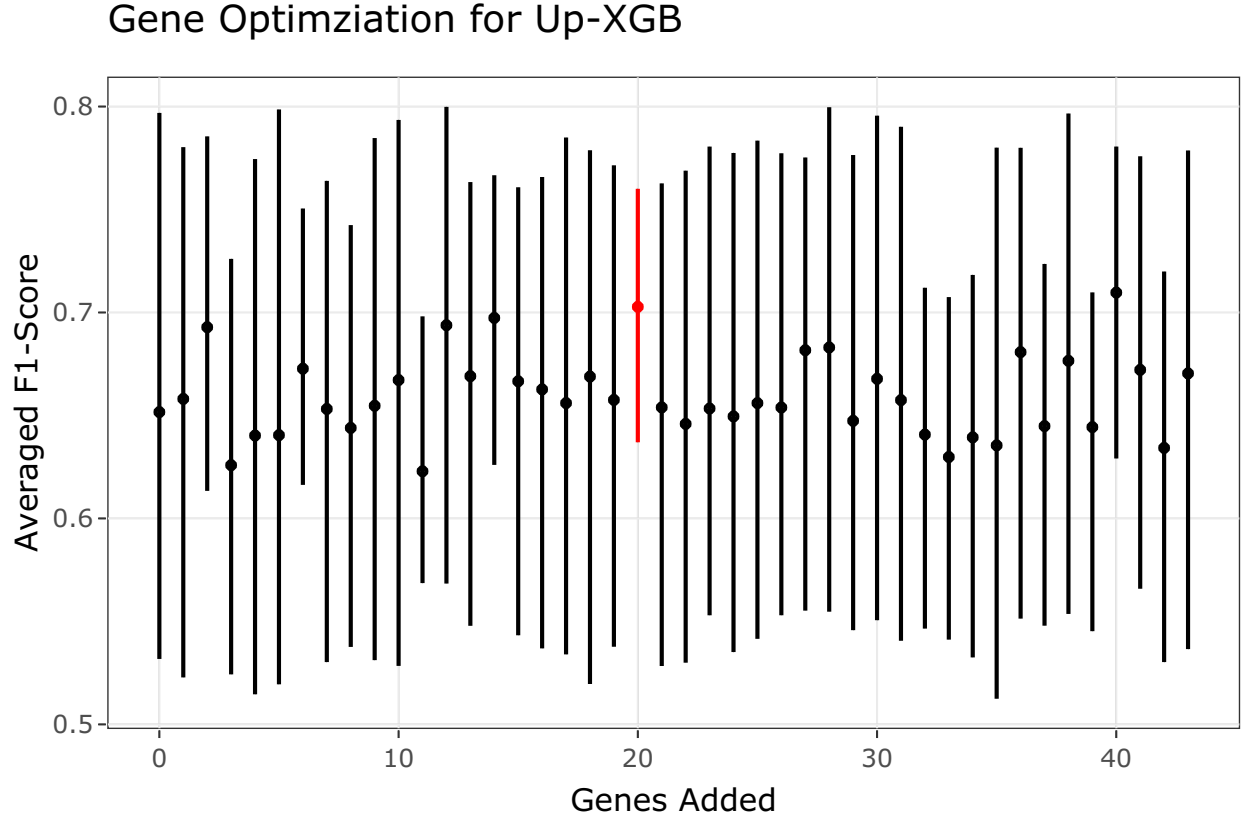


Figure 4.19: Gene Optimization for Up-XGB Classifier using Averaged F1-Score

In the Up-XGB classifier, the optimal number of genes is achieved at the highest averaged F1-score with 20 genes added, highlighted in red in Figure 4.19. Hence the optimal number of total genes used will be $n=28+20=48$.

The gene profile of the optimal set of genes used is displayed in Table 4.16. Base genes in the PrOTYPE and SPOT sets are annotated with green circles, and the added genes are annotated with yellow circles. The added genes are: HNF1B, TPX2, TFF1, CYP2C18, TFF3, WT1, GPR64, KLK7, SLC3A1, IGFBP1, GAD1, LGALS4, MET, GCNT3, FUT3, C1orf173, EGFL6, MUC5B, C10orf116 and DKK4. Unused genes are annotated with red crosses.

Table 4.16: Gene Profile of Optimal Set in Up-XGB Workflow

Set	Genes	PrOTYPE	SPOT	Optimal Set	Candidate Rank
	COL11A1	v		(*)	
	CD74	v		(*)	
	CD2	v		(*)	
	TIMP3	v		(*)	

Base	LUM	v	(*)	
	CYTIP	v	(*)	
	COL3A1	v	(*)	
	THBS2	v	(*)	
	TCF7L1	v	v	(*)
	HMGA2	v		(*)
	FN1	v		(*)
	POSTN	v		(*)
	COL1A2	v		(*)
	COL5A2	v		(*)
	PDZK1IP1	v		(*)
	FBN1	v		(*)
	HIF1A		v	(*)
	CXCL10		v	(*)
	DUSP4		v	(*)
	SOX17		v	(*)
	MITF		v	(*)
	CDKN3		v	(*)
	BRCA2		v	(*)
	CEACAM5		v	(*)
	ANXA4		v	(*)
	SERPINE1		v	(*)
	CRABP2		v	(*)
	DNAJC9		v	(*)
	HNF1B			(*) 1
	TPX2			(*) 2
	TFF1			(*) 3
	CYP2C18			(*) 4
	TFF3			(*) 5
	WT1			(*) 6
	GPR64			(*) 7
	KLK7			(*) 8
	SLC3A1			(*) 9
	IGFBP1			(*) 10

Candidates	GAD1	(*)	11
	LGALS4	(*)	12
	MET	(*)	13
	GCNT3	(*)	14
	FUT3	(*)	15
	C1orf173	(*)	16
	EGFL6	(*)	17
	MUC5B	(*)	18
	C10orf116	(*)	19
	DKK4	(*)	20
	IL6	(x)	21
	CAPN2	(x)	22
	KGFLP2	(x)	23
	BRCA1	(x)	24
	CYP4B1	(x)	25
	IGKC	(x)	26
	PBX1	(x)	27
	TSPAN8	(x)	28
	SEMA6A	(x)	29
	SENP8	(x)	30
	PAX8	(x)	31
	TP53	(x)	32
	SERPINA5	(x)	33
	ATP5G3	(x)	34
	CPNE8	(x)	35
	LIN28B	(x)	36
	STC1	(x)	37
	EPAS1	(x)	38
	BCL2	(x)	39
	MAP1LC3A	(x)	40
	SCGB1D2	(x)	41
	ADCYAP1R1	(x)	42
	IGJ	(x)	43

4.4.3 Gene List Comparisons in Confirmation Set

We train the SMOTE-SVM and Up-XGB workflows using the base and optimal gene lists in the training set. The models are evaluated on the confirmation set. Overall and per-class results are shown in Table 4.17. The gene lists are:

1. Base (n=28): among the overlapping genes, the base set from the PrOTYPE and SPOT lists
2. Optimal (n=53, 48): among the overlapping genes, the base set plus the additional number of genes that result in the optimal value for a selected evaluation metric, as assessed in Figure 4.18 and Figure 4.19

Table 4.17: Model Comparisons using Different Gene Lists in Confirmation Set

Method	Metric	Overall	Histotypes				
			HGSOC	CCOC	ENOC	MUOC	LGSOC
SMOTE-SVM, Optimal	Accuracy	0.830	0.869	0.963	0.879	0.975	0.975
	Sensitivity	0.669	0.941	0.806	0.505	0.593	0.500
	Specificity	0.928	0.729	0.982	0.953	0.992	0.984
	F1-Score	0.682	0.905	0.829	0.581	0.667	0.429
	Balanced Accuracy	0.798	0.835	0.894	0.729	0.792	0.742
	Kappa	0.657	0.697	0.808	0.511	0.654	0.416
SMOTE-SVM, Base	Accuracy	0.815	0.860	0.952	0.874	0.970	0.974
	Sensitivity	0.672	0.903	0.889	0.514	0.556	0.500
	Specificity	0.930	0.775	0.960	0.946	0.989	0.983
	F1-Score	0.660	0.895	0.805	0.576	0.612	0.414
	Balanced Accuracy	0.801	0.839	0.924	0.730	0.772	0.741
	Kappa	0.641	0.685	0.778	0.503	0.597	0.401
Up-XGB, Optimal	Accuracy	0.840	0.866	0.972	0.893	0.977	0.972
	Sensitivity	0.618	0.962	0.875	0.458	0.630	0.167
	Specificity	0.924	0.679	0.984	0.979	0.992	0.987
	F1-Score	0.648	0.905	0.875	0.587	0.694	0.182
	Balanced Accuracy	0.771	0.821	0.930	0.719	0.811	0.577
	Kappa	0.665	0.682	0.859	0.531	0.682	0.168
Up-XGB, Base	Accuracy	0.808	0.854	0.953	0.861	0.974	0.975
	Sensitivity	0.593	0.950	0.875	0.308	0.667	0.167
	Specificity	0.916	0.665	0.963	0.972	0.987	0.990
	F1-Score	0.602	0.896	0.808	0.426	0.679	0.200
	Balanced Accuracy	0.754	0.808	0.919	0.640	0.827	0.579
	Kappa	0.602	0.653	0.781	0.360	0.665	0.188

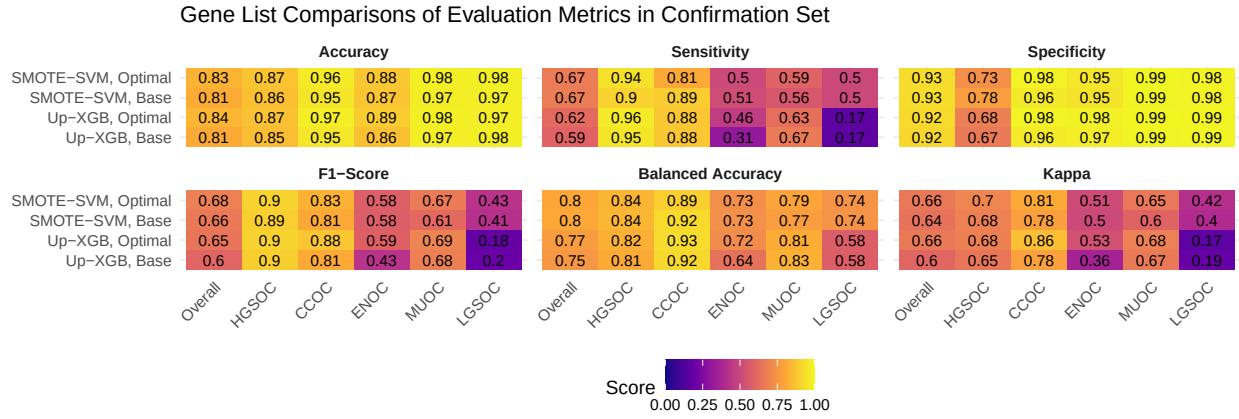


Figure 4.20: Gene List Comparisons of Evaluation Metrics in Confirmation Set

4.5 Validation Set

Based on the results in Figure 4.20, we assess the SMOTE-SVM model trained on the training set for the optimal and all overlap gene lists, evaluating in the validation set.

4.5.1 Evaluation Metrics

Table 4.18: Evaluation Metrics on Training Set Models in Validation Set

Method	Metric	Overall	Histotypes				
			HGSOC	CCOC	ENOC	MUOC	LGSOC
SMOTE-SVM, All Overlap	Accuracy	0.884	0.908	0.959	0.950	0.970	0.981
	Sensitivity	0.792	0.908	0.986	0.682	0.600	0.783
	Specificity	0.961	0.908	0.956	0.979	0.976	0.986
	F1-Score	0.706	0.939	0.786	0.727	0.400	0.679
	Balanced Accuracy	0.876	0.908	0.971	0.830	0.788	0.884
	Kappa	0.716	0.752	0.764	0.700	0.386	0.670
SMOTE-SVM, Optimal	Accuracy	0.875	0.902	0.963	0.946	0.966	0.972
	Sensitivity	0.756	0.907	0.942	0.659	0.533	0.739
	Specificity	0.955	0.882	0.965	0.978	0.974	0.978
	F1-Score	0.673	0.935	0.798	0.707	0.348	0.576
	Balanced Accuracy	0.856	0.895	0.953	0.818	0.754	0.859
	Kappa	0.692	0.732	0.778	0.678	0.333	0.563
SMOTE-SVM, Base	Accuracy	0.834	0.865	0.953	0.921	0.960	0.971
	Sensitivity	0.717	0.877	0.957	0.477	0.533	0.739
	Specificity	0.937	0.821	0.953	0.969	0.967	0.977
	F1-Score	0.617	0.910	0.759	0.542	0.308	0.567
	Balanced Accuracy	0.827	0.849	0.955	0.723	0.750	0.858
	Kappa	0.601	0.637	0.734	0.499	0.291	0.552

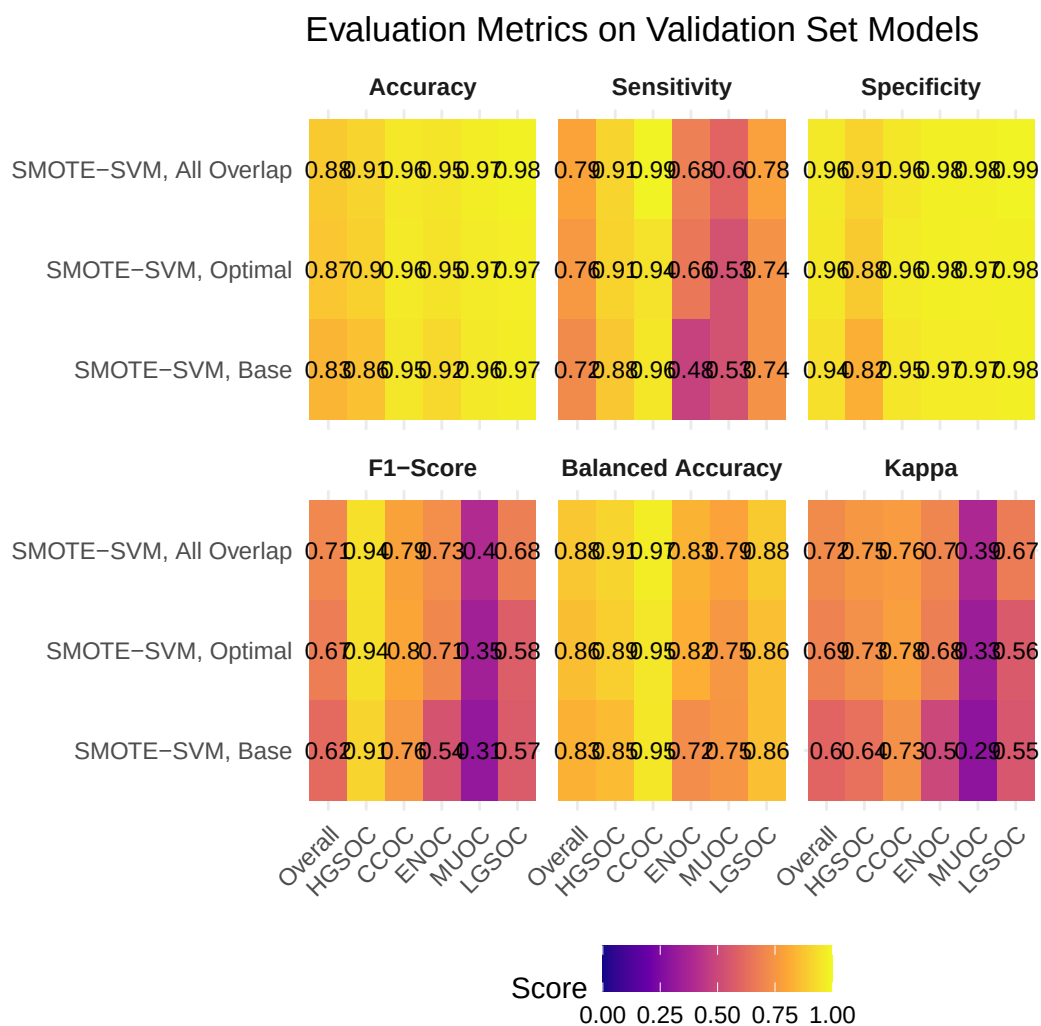


Figure 4.21: Evaluation Metrics on Validation Set Models

4.5.2 Confusion Matrices

Confusion Matrix for Training Set Models evaluated on Validation Data

A

SMOTE-SVM, All Overlap

	HGSOC	635	0	16	2	0
	CCOC	26	68	7	0	3
	ENOC	12	1	60	2	2
	MUOC	21	0	0	9	0
	LGSOC	5	0	5	2	18
Prediction		HGSOC	CCOC	ENOC	MUOC	LGSOC
		Truth				

B

SMOTE-SVM, Optimal

	HGSOC	634	0	19	3	1
	CCOC	23	65	4	0	2
	ENOC	10	2	58	3	3
	MUOC	23	0	0	8	0
	LGSOC	9	2	7	1	17
Prediction		HGSOC	CCOC	ENOC	MUOC	LGSOC
		Truth				

C

SMOTE-SVM, Base

	HGSOC	613	0	32	2	1
	CCOC	27	66	8	0	4
	ENOC	19	2	42	3	1
	MUOC	27	0	2	8	0
	LGSOC	13	1	4	2	17
Prediction		HGSOC	CCOC	ENOC	MUOC	LGSOC
		Truth				

Figure 4.22: Confusion Matrix for Training Set Models evaluated on Validation Data

4.5.3 ROC Curves

4.5.3.1 All Overlap

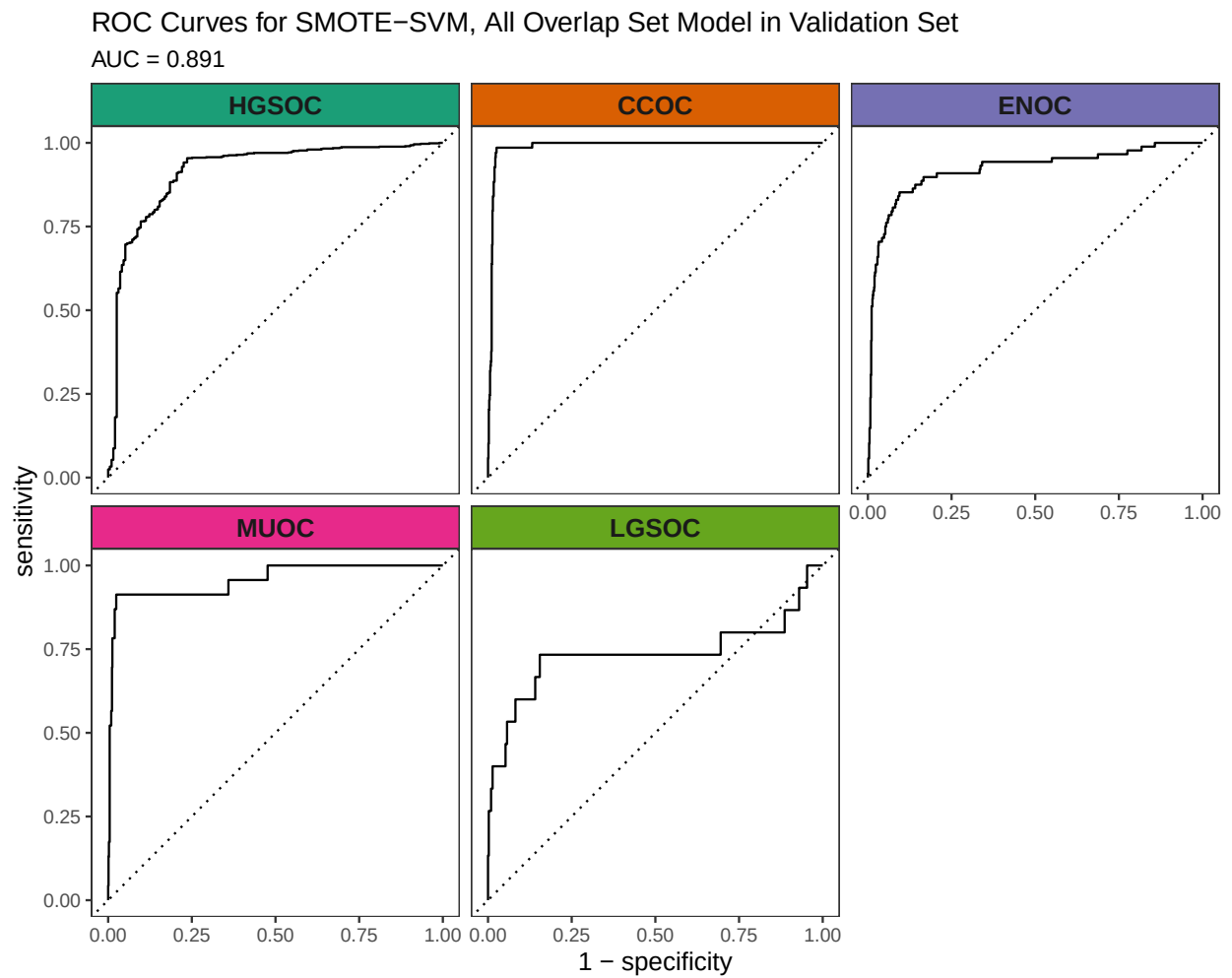


Figure 4.23: ROC Curves for SMOTE-SVM, All Overlap Set Model in Validation Set

4.5.3.2 Optimal Set

ROC Curves for SMOTE-SVM, Optimal Set Model in Validation Set

AUC = 0.867

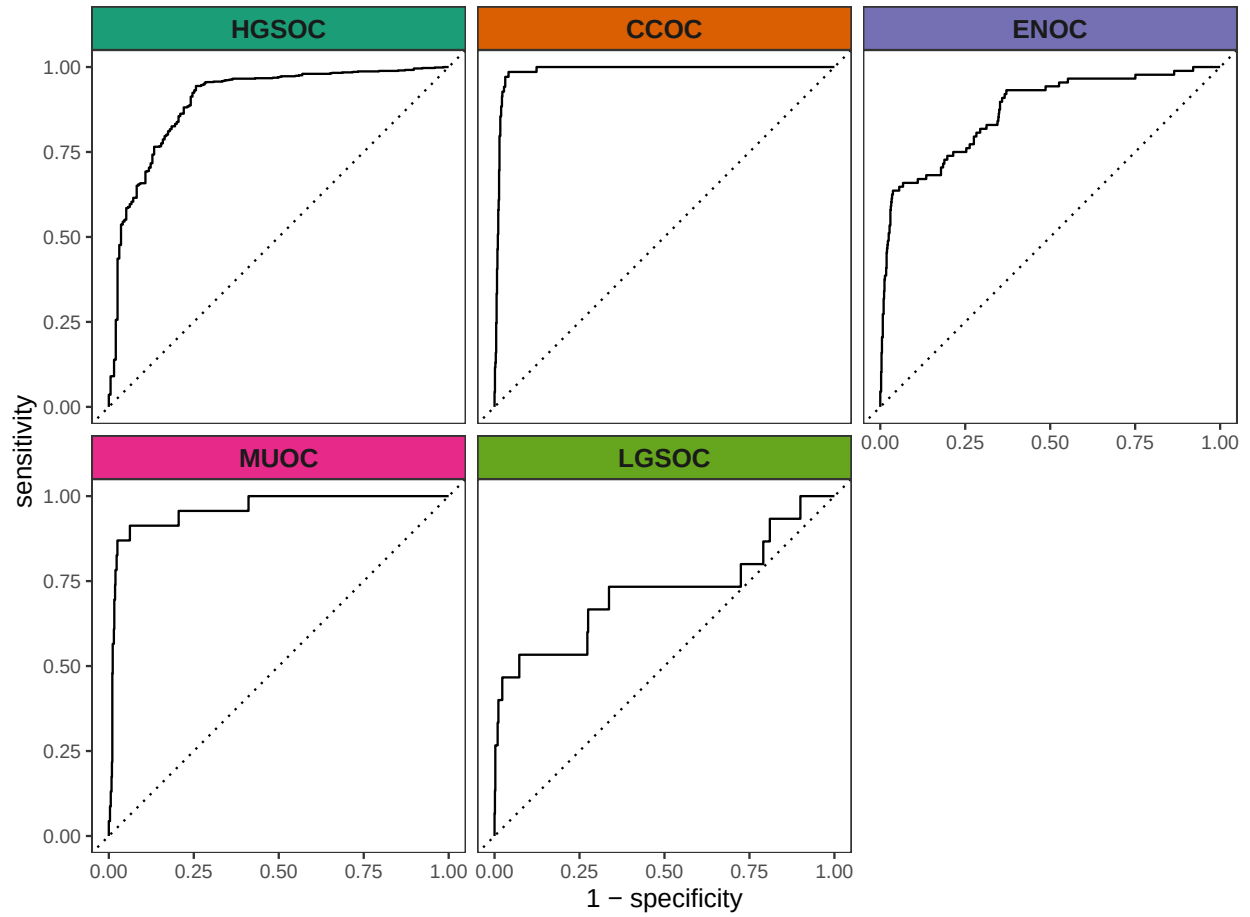


Figure 4.24: ROC Curves for SMOTE-SVM, Optimal Set Model in Validation Set

4.5.3.3 Base Set

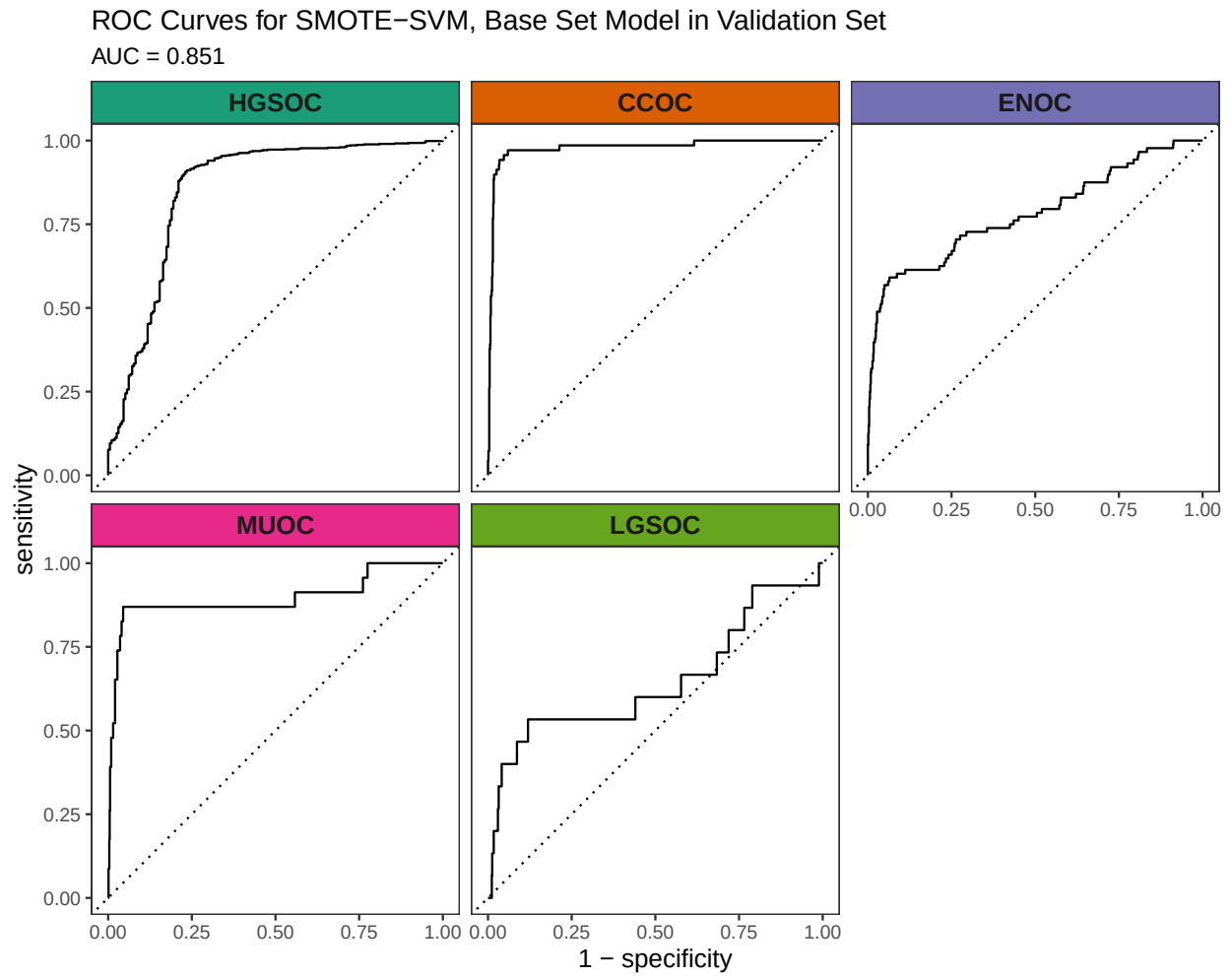


Figure 4.25: ROC Curves for SMOTE-SVM, Base Set Model in Validation Set

4.5.4 Calibration Plots

4.5.4.1 All Overlap

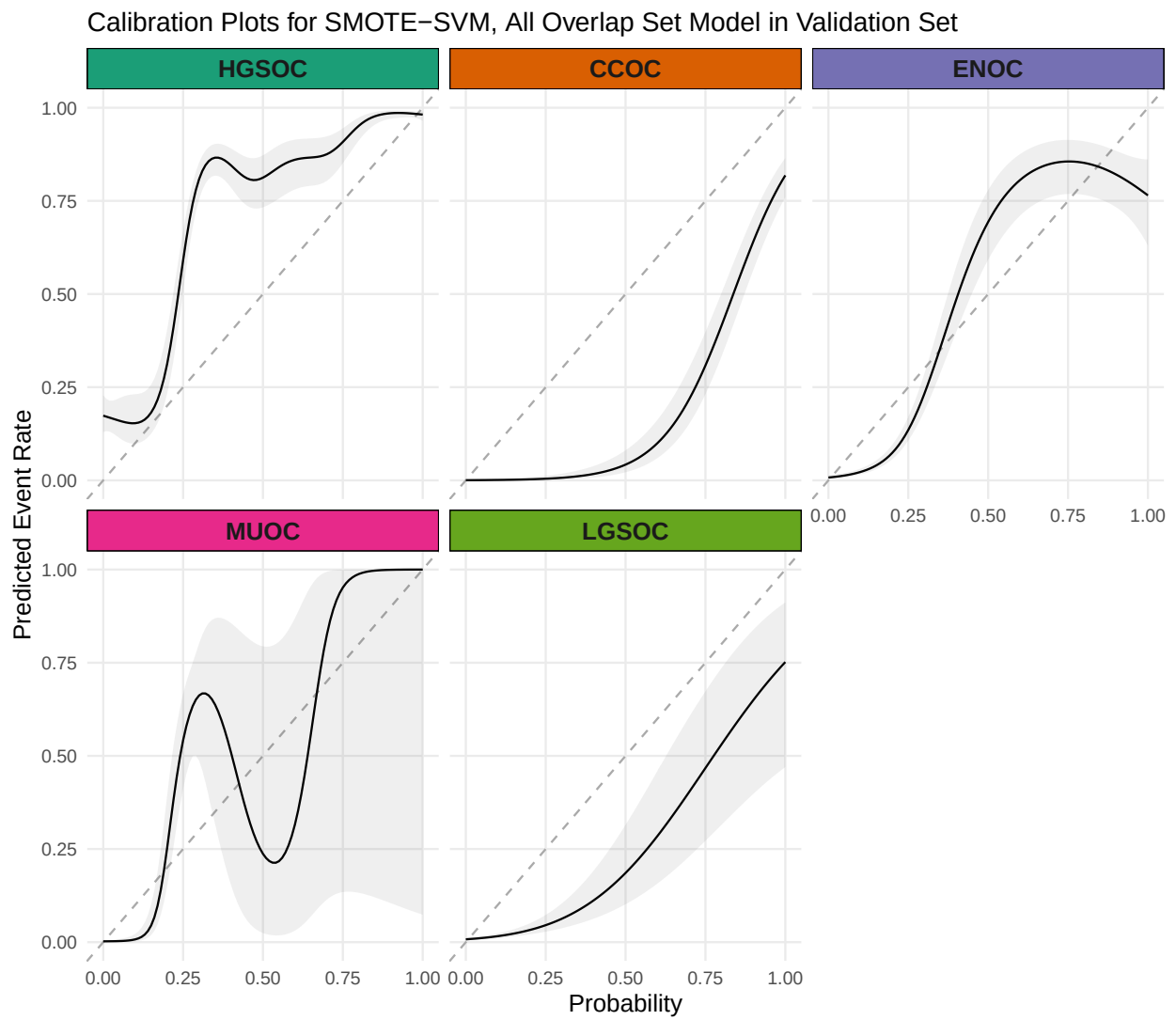


Figure 4.26: Calibration Plots for SMOTE-SVM, All Overlap Set Model in Validation Set

4.5.4.2 Optimal Set

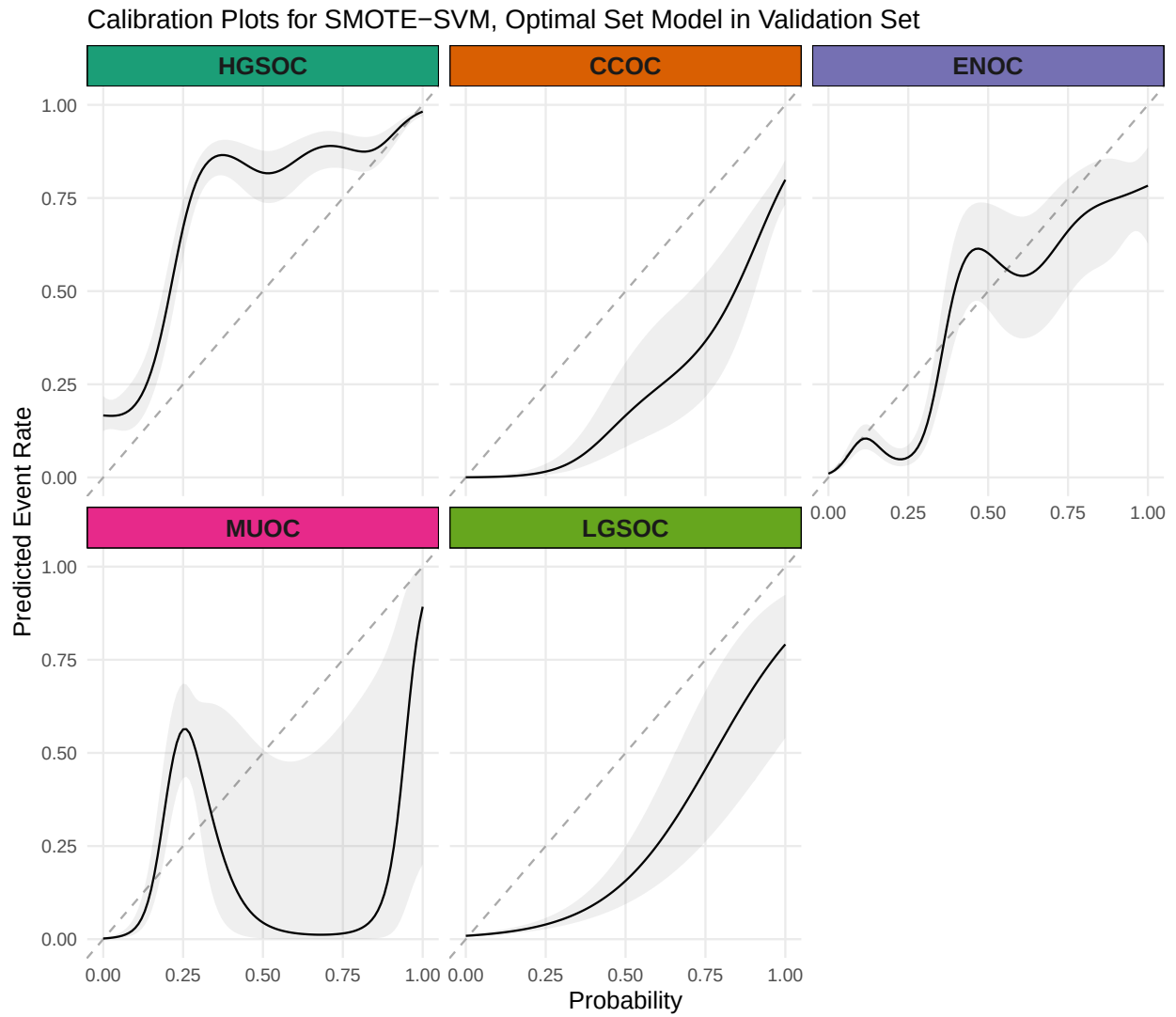


Figure 4.27: Calibration Plots for SMOTE-SVM, Optimal Set Model in Validation Set

4.5.4.3 Base Set

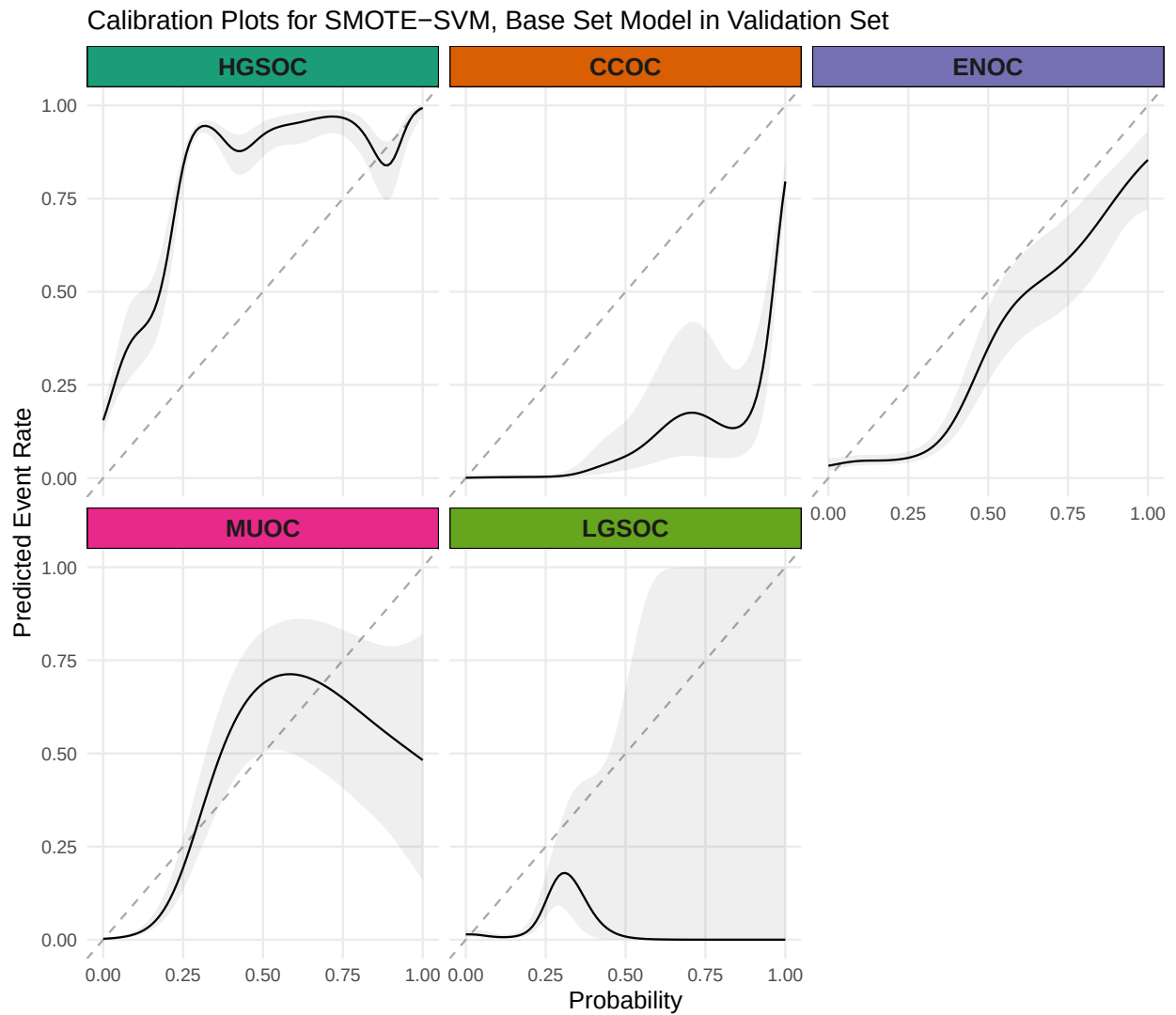


Figure 4.28: Calibration Plots for SMOTE-SVM, Base Set Model in Validation Set

4.5.5 Summary

A summary of the SMOTE-SVM, Optimal model results are shown in Figure [4.29](#).

SMOTE-SVM, Optimal Set Summary in Validation Set

A

Confusion Matrix

Prediction	HGSOC	634	0	19	3	1
	CCOC	23	65	4	0	2
	ENOC	10	2	58	3	3
	MUOC	23	0	0	8	0
	LGSOC	9	2	7	1	17
	Truth	HGSOC	CCOC	ENOC	MUOC	LGSOC

C

Metric	Overall	HGSOC	CCOC	ENOC	MUOC	LGSOC
Accuracy	0.875	0.902	0.963	0.946	0.966	0.972
Sensitivity	0.756	0.907	0.942	0.659	0.533	0.739
Specificity	0.955	0.882	0.965	0.978	0.974	0.978
F1-Score	0.673	0.935	0.798	0.707	0.348	0.576
Balanced Accuracy	0.856	0.895	0.953	0.818	0.754	0.859
Kappa	0.692	0.732	0.778	0.678	0.333	0.563

B

ROC Curves

AUC = 0.867

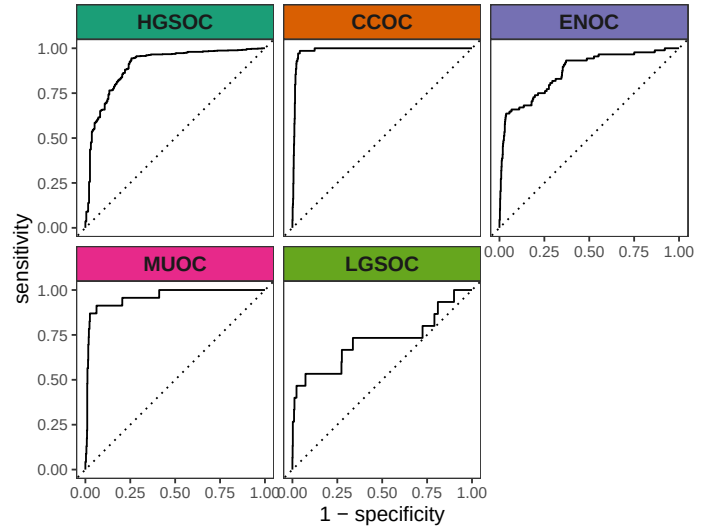


Figure 4.29: Validation Summary

4.5.6 Additional Explorations

Table 4.19: Clinicopath characteristics between correct and incorrect predictions of ENOC cases

Characteristic	Predicted ENOC Correctly N = 58 ¹	Missed ENOC N = 30 ¹
Age at diagnosis	53 (46, 64)	57 (51, 62)
Tumour grade		
low grade	45 (94%)	14 (58%)
high grade	3 (6.3%)	10 (42%)
Unknown	10	6
FIGO tumour stage		
I	45 (79%)	17 (57%)
II-IV	12 (21%)	13 (43%)
Unknown	1	0
Race		
white	51 (91%)	25 (93%)
non-white	5 (8.9%)	2 (7.4%)
Unknown	2	3
ARID1A		
absent/subclonal	11 (19%)	5 (17%)
present	47 (81%)	25 (83%)
WT1		
diffuse (>50%)	2 (3.4%)	3 (10%)
focal (1-50%)	3 (5.2%)	0 (0%)
negative	53 (91%)	27 (90%)
TP53		
mutated	1 (1.7%)	4 (14%)
wild type	57 (98%)	25 (86%)
Unknown	0	1
PR		
diffuse (>50%)	38 (66%)	8 (27%)
focal (1-50%)	11 (19%)	4 (13%)
negative	9 (16%)	18 (60%)
P16		
abnormal block	1 (1.7%)	5 (17%)
abnormal complete absence	14 (24%)	11 (37%)
normal	43 (74%)	14 (47%)
NAPSIN A		
negative	56 (97%)	29 (100%)
positive	2 (3.4%)	0 (0%)
Unknown	0	1

¹Median (Q1, Q3); n (%)

²Wilcoxon rank sum test; Fisher's exact test; Pearson's Chi-squared test

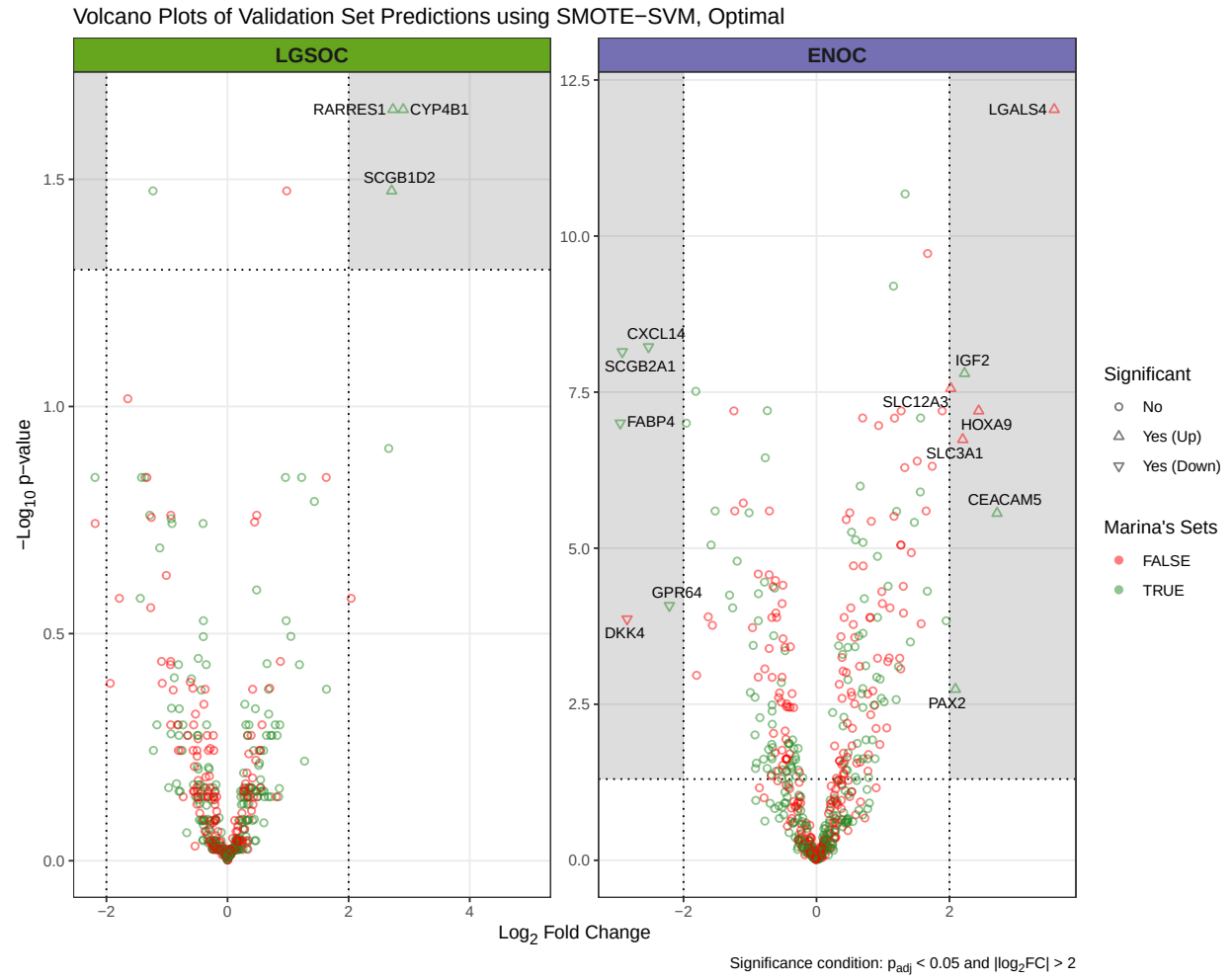


Figure 4.30: Volcano Plots of Validation Set Predictions

Boxplot of Most Differentially Expressed Genes

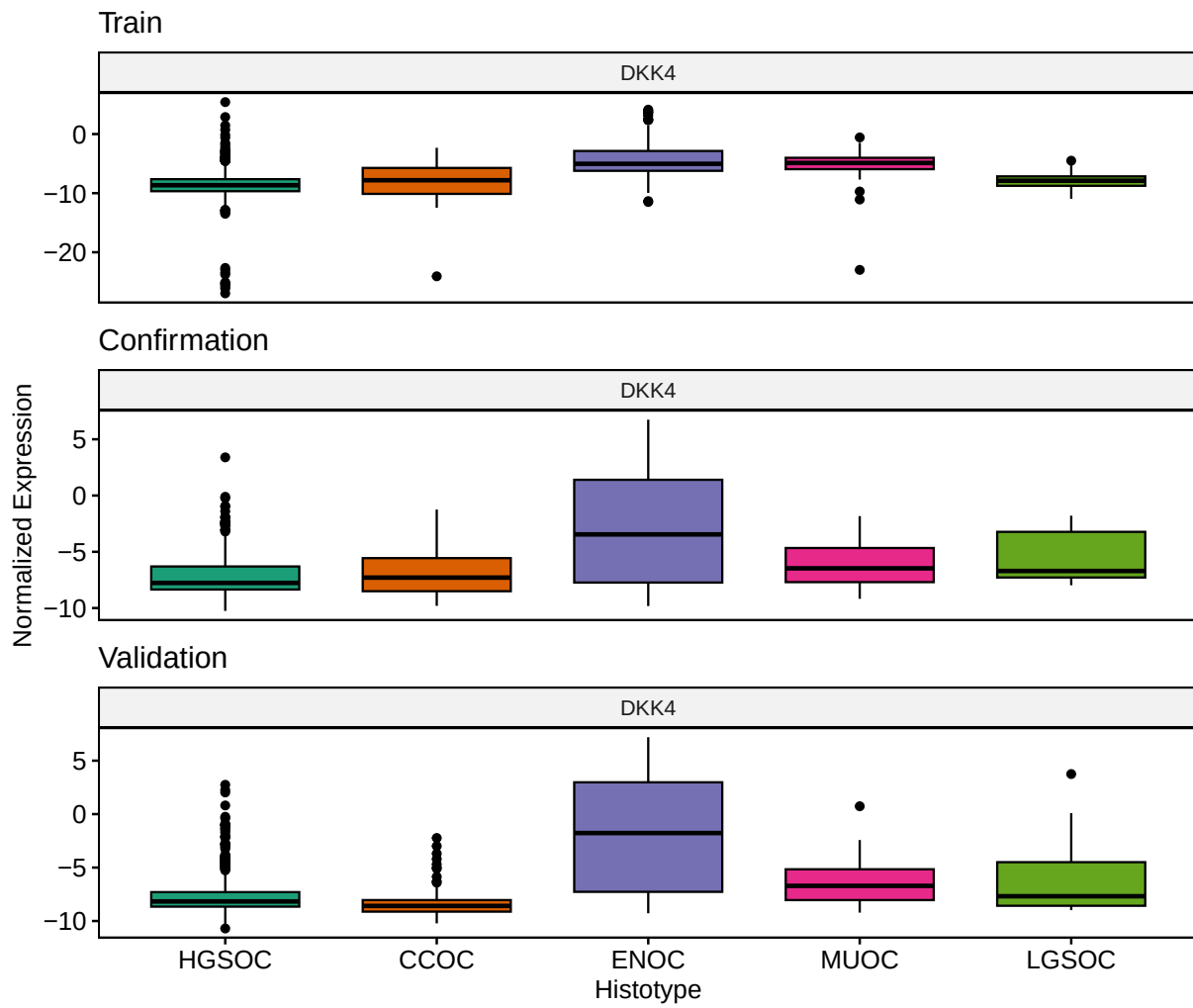


Figure 4.31: Boxplot of Most Differentially Expressed Genes

Subtype Prediction Summary among Predicted HGSC Samples

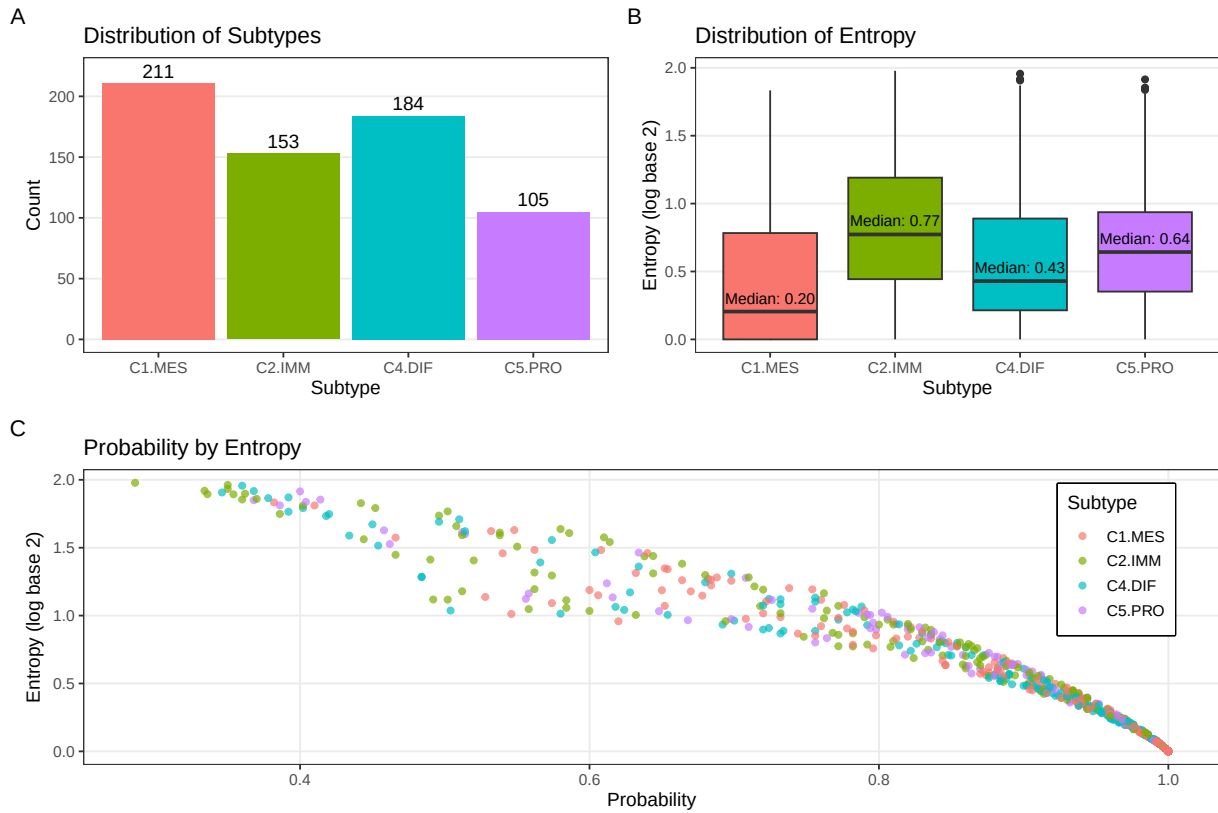


Figure 4.32: Subtype Prediction Summary among Predicted HGSC Samples

References

- Pihur, Vasyl, Susmita Datta, and Somnath Datta. 2009. “RankAggreg, an r Package for Weighted Rank Aggregation.” *BMC Bioinformatics* 10 (1): 62.
- Talhouk, Aline, Stefan Kommoss, Robertson Mackenzie, et al. 2016. “Single-Patient Molecular Testing with NanoString nCounter Data Using a Reference-Based Strategy for Batch Effect Correction.” *PLOS ONE* 11 (4): e0153844. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0153844>.